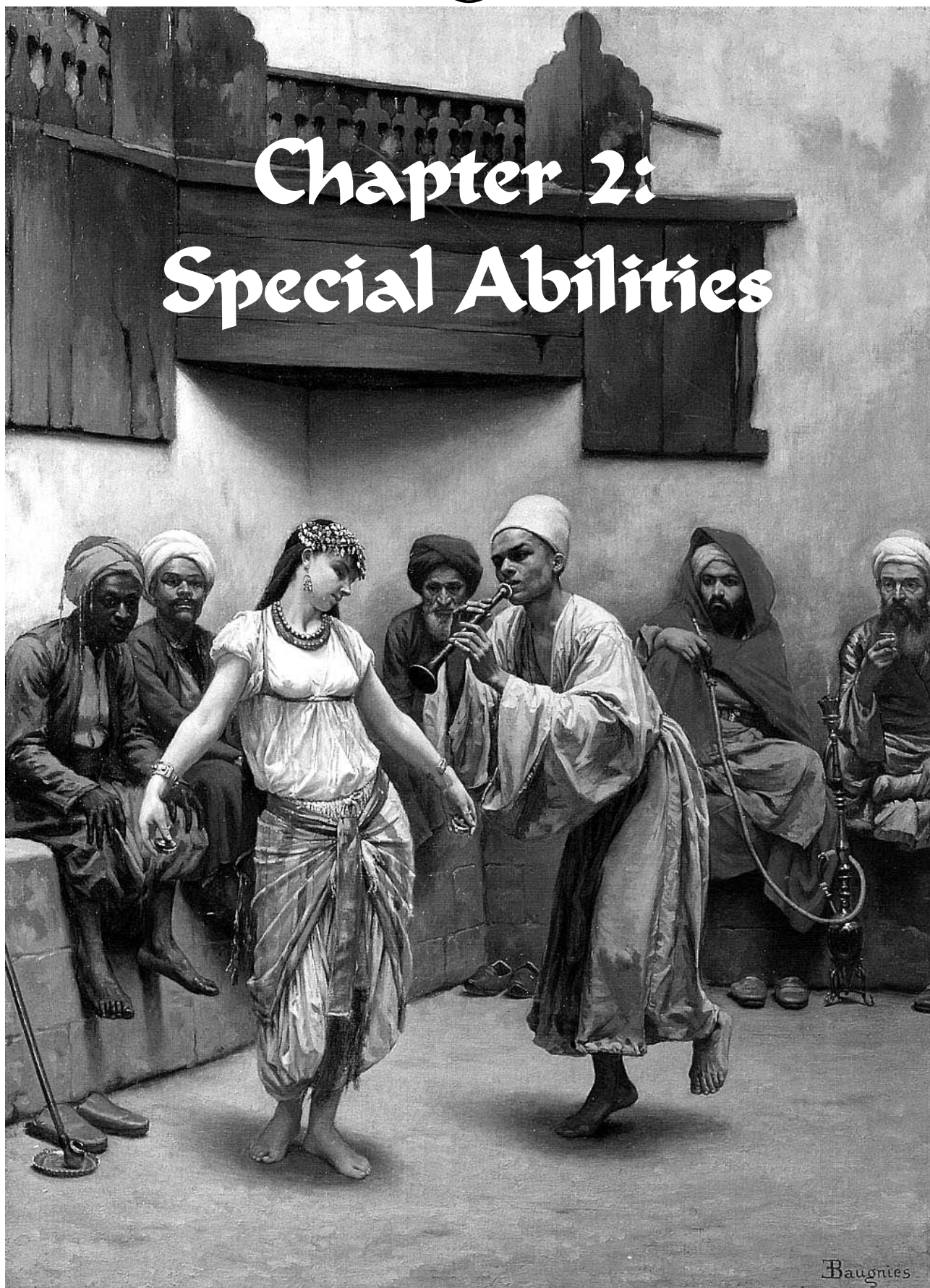




Chapter 2: Special Abilities



Baugnies

Ability Modifiers

Ability modifiers cover the variations. Can it only be used when the character has an audience? Then it's probably Specialized. Does it cause a single point of attribute damage? Then it's probably Corrupted. While ability modifiers are usually applied only to special abilities, characters can have them on basic abilities. This commonly crops up in special saving throw bonuses against particular attacks, in attack bonuses usable only against certain creatures, or in magic levels with severe restrictions (see page 15).

Corrupted. A Corrupted feat or ability is either more limited than usual or comes with some sort of downside. The effect of such a feat or ability is increased by 50% or it costs only 2/3 the normal price.

For example, Ulric wants to buy Alchemical Hedge Magic using the Paladin/Ranger chart and an alchemically-based spell list.

Alchemical Hedge Magician Spell List

L0: *Brew* (makes instant tea), *Detect Poison*, *Flare*, *Glue* (sticks things together), *Identify Herb* (obvious), *Phosphorescence* (light), *Smoke Cloud* (makes a big puff of smoke) and *Spray* (sprays a vial of something on a nearby target).

L1: *Bless (or Curse) Water*, *Cure Light Wounds*, *Distillation* (doubles the effect of a standard alchemical compound for 2 XP), *Entangle*, *Fastburn* (turns a burning object into a small explosion), *Magic Weapon*, *Obscuring Mist* and *Resist Energy*.

L2: *Alchemic Mist* (turns a vial of something into a small cloud), *Blindness/Deafness*, *Delay Poison*, *Fire Trap*, *Glitterdust*, *Acid Arrow*, *Pyrotechnics* and *Soften Earth and Stone*.

L3: *Antitoxin* (Neutralize Poison), *Cure Moderate Wounds*, *Dispel Magic*, *Ectoplasm* (Shadow Conjunction), *Haste*, *Magic Circle* (immobile but affects all alignments), *The Naming of Names* (attempts to control someone by invoking their true name. Nothing to do with alchemy, but it's a basic component of magic in the campaign, so OK), and *Poison* (can produce various toxins, not just Con poison).

L4: *Break Enchantment*, *Hold Monster*, *Rusting Grasp*, *Protoplasmic Salve* (cures only 3d6 damage and takes several minute to cast, otherwise as per *Heal*), *Stoneskin*, *Touch of Alkahest* (as per *Disintegrate*, but

requires a touch attack since it has no range, resistance to acid applies, the damage is distributed over several rounds, it can be stopped by washing it off or applying a base, and it's capped at 30d6. It may be pushing it, but the GM allows it), and *Vital Elixir* (a combined version of *Bull's Strength*, *Bear's Endurance*, and *Cat's Grace*; OK at level four).

Like a Paladin or Ranger's spell list, these spells are available to any alchemical hedge mage, but must be prepared in advance.

Ulric wants to Corrupt the list, increasing his effective level in the progression by 50%, by making casting his spells require an Alchemy skill check at a DC of [(Spell Level +1) x 5] and an alchemical lab to prepare since they all revolve around tossing alchemical compounds around. Fair enough.

Specialized. The ability is only usable in a very limited situation or is otherwise severely restricted. This either doubles the effect or halves the cost. This may often be applied to feats which require substantial psychic energy to function or need extra preparation.

- An ability that normally requires a specific situation or other Specialization can't be cheated. If a character buys all of his or her special attacks and abilities for the weapon he or she uses all the time, this isn't much of a flaw unless the Game Master then makes a point of taking away that weapon occasionally. Characters may come in for an ECL penalty if they specialize too much, as per "Keeping characters under control," page 163.

- Many abilities note that they apply only in "certain circumstances" or "special situations." If you want to Specialize or Corrupt these, you're going to have to limit them even further.

Ulric wants to make his alchemy cheaper. He wants to Specialize it by reducing the number of spells he can recover per day to 1d6 levels of spells (level zero spells count as 1/2 a spell level) per two hours of work with a trunkful of alchemical equipment. That's fairly reasonable and his spell list doesn't seem likely to break the game. Still, the GM warns the player that, if this does turn out to be a problem, he may run short on some rare or expensive alchemical catalyst and so find it harder to renew his spells.

Bonus Uses (+6 CP). Bonus Uses increases the number of times the user may indulge in a times-per-day (or other appropriate period) ability by +4. At GMO, the character may add a relevant attribute modifier to the number of uses instead. Bonus Uses may be purchased repeatedly.

- With the GM's permission, you may add more uses at +1/2/3/4 uses for 2/3/5/6 additional CP's.

Basic Abilities

Reading the Entries. Now and then you'll see entries like this: "This costs +6/12/18 CP for spells of level 1-6/7-8/9." What does this mean? It means the entry has a variable cost depending on how powerful an effect you buy. In the above example, the extra cost for buying a spell from level 1 through 6 is 6 character points. This rises to 12 character points for spell of levels 7 and 8, or 18 points for level 9 spells. Just count the slashes if there's any question.

Some talents grant multiple abilities. Abilities listed with a (+) sign next to the CP cost require the basic ability (i.e., the first one named).

Most of these abilities are extraordinary. As a rule, only those which grant actual magical powers are spell-like or supernatural. This doesn't mean that you can't turn them into supernatural powers by corrupting them, but this isn't really recommended: sooner or later someone will use a major antimagic effect. If word gets out, and a character used this flaw too much, they'll become unplayable. Certainly no evil mastermind would go without a way to counter some over-enchanted hero or heroine!

Moreover, characters (and often players) have few ways of discovering whether an ability is supernatural or not, except by trial and error. If the characters neither know nor care about their own abilities, why worry about it?



Why, yes, I am a Hero! How could you tell?

Ability Focus (3 or 6 CP). You add +2 to the DC of resisting one of your specific abilities, such as a breath weapon, special ability, particular spell, or specific poison. At 6 CP this may be expanded to a particular school, technique, descriptor, domain, or path of magic, a small group of innate magical abilities, or another modest group of abilities.

- For double the base cost (+3 or +6 CP) the DC of the ability or abilities in question may be increased by +4.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it affects another ability.

Acrobatics (6 CP). Acrobatics allows you to combine several physical stunts into one roll. An example might be, "I flip over the railing, grab the chandelier, swing across the room, tumble out the window, and land on my horse!" This would require one roll, at the highest DC incurred by any single action. You may thus evade some checks; in the example above the character wouldn't need to make any Jump checks because the Tumble check has the highest DC involved.

- **Light Foot** (+6 CP) allows combining an impractical maneuver with normal movement, such as running on walls or turning in midair while jumping.

Action Hero (6 CP). You gain (2 + level) Action Points each time you gain a level and may accumulate a pool of up to (2 x level + 10) Action Points at any one time. Characters must select one of the options below to spend Action Points on each time they purchase Action Hero.

For each additional +2 CP you gain one extra AP per level and +2 to the maximum you can accumulate in your pool. If you want to fuel other abilities with AP, they can normally be purchased as Specialized.

- **Heroism** allows you to spend one Action Point per round to improve a single character-action roll (NOT a hit point or other character development check) by 1d6. At level 8+ roll 2d6 and apply the best one, at 15+ roll 3d6 and apply the best one, and at 22+ roll 4d6 and apply the best one. Totaled multiple rolls, such as the damage from a *Fireball* or a high-level rogue's Sneak Attack, may add the total instead of keeping only the best die. An Action Point may be spent on Heroism after the roll is made, but must be spent before the Game Master announces the result. Action Points cannot be used if you're "Taking 10" or "Taking 20."

For +3 CP you may roll d8's instead of d6's. For a further +3 CP you may roll d10's instead of d8's. For another +6 CP, you may spend two action points per round if you want to. Finally, for +6 CP more, you may spend one AP per day without having to reduce your reserve. This last option is NOT usable with any of the other expenditure options.



- *Stunt* temporarily enhances your current abilities by a total of +6 CP. Constant-effect abilities purchased in this fashion work for one minute. Other abilities last for one round. In any case, the extra CP can only be used to enhance abilities related to your current talents and must be approved by the Game Master. They may, however, exceed the normal purchase limits. “Stunts” may be Corrupted or Specialized under the usual rules.

Popular uses of this ability include taking an extra Standard Action (Reflex Training), gaining an extra use of any “uses-per-time period” ability (Bonus Uses), or automatically stabilizing your condition (Grant of Aid). “Taking 20” when this is not normally allowed (Luck), making a mighty effort (Hysteria), instantly refreshing a spell slot (Invocation), or “throwing off” mental influences (Immunity; the influence is gone for good if the power in question has a specified duration, but comes back after a minute if it’s permanent) are also popular.

- *Crafting* lets a character with the appropriate skills and abilities expend Action Points in lieu of the time and XP that would normally be required to complete a project; the user is simply presumed to “have been working on it.” In general, it costs 1 AP to complete a minor project, such as forging a masterwork dagger, scribing a couple of ordinary scrolls, or brewing a couple of potions. Notable projects, such as a wand, cost 3. Impressive projects, such as building a small boat or a minor permanent enchantment, cost 6. Major projects, such as building a private tower in the woods, enchanting midrange permanent items, or making a lesser magical staff, cost 10. Huge projects, such as enchanting a ship, creating a powerful permanent item, or making a major magical staff, cost 15. Finally, Grandiose projects, such as creating an epic item or building a fortification, cost 21.

Crafting is useful in games which don’t allow a lot of downtime for would-be crafters and enchanters to work in. Without it they may never get to use the abilities they’ve purchased. The Game Master is entitled to some advance notice of any project worth 10 AP or more.

- *Invention* lets a character expend Action Points to develop new technologies, jury-rig equipment, create new spells, or simply to have brilliant ideas (i.e., getting a suggestion from the Game Master). A simple idea costs a mere 1 AP and a temporary jury-rig costs 1d3. Inventions are quite expensive, however.

A minor improvement to an existing design costs 2 AP, an original design 4 AP, a minor innovation 7, a notable development 10, a dramatic discovery 15, and brand new fields of technology 25. Paying the base costs results in a prototype that only the inventor can effectively use or maintain. Twice that allows the inventor to make and sell the item, but others cannot - although they may begin investing AP in the invention as well. When the total reaches three times the base cost, the device can be duplicated by the creator’s students. At four times the base AP cost specialists throughout the

campaign will be able to make devices using the principles of the item, and at five times the base AP cost, it becomes generally available.

- *Influence* allows you to spend AP to manipulate large-scale events. For example, a minor change, such as getting the taxes on a village reduced or forgiven for a year, would cost 1 AP. Getting backing for an expedition or getting someone pardoned for a fairly serious offence might cost 3. Impressive requests, such as a raid or rescue expedition across a border, cost 6. Major changes, such as settling an inheritance dispute or getting a grant of lands might cost 10. Huge changes, such as getting a modest war started or settled, cost 15. Grandiose changes, such as changing a state religion or starting a crusade, cost 21.

Influence is particularly useful when some of the players want to meddle in politics while the others simply want to fight things.

Adaptation (6 CP). Adaptation allows you to become accustomed to a stressful environment, position, or situation, avoiding its penalties. For example, you can become used to fighting while prone, while on the pitching deck of a ship, while climbing, or while in zero- or high-gravity environments. Adaption to the desert or to an arctic environment would negate the effects of environmental stress, movement penalties, and similar annoyances in that environment. A social specialist could even become used to working with a hostile audience, and no longer suffer penalties to his or her skills in such situations. Unless combined with some form of Damage Reduction, or other appropriate defense, Adaption does not suffice for survival in environments which inflict damage on a per-round basis.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it affects another combat situation or environment.

Adept (6 CP). Select four related (i.e., get your GM’s permission) skills, which you learn for half price. Each rank of a relevant skill now costs only 1/2 CP. Each rank of an irrelevant one now costs only 1 CP.

- You may take this ability twice, affecting two groups of skills, if your Game Master gives you permission.

Adept is actually one of the most powerful abilities in the system. It provides a huge skill bonus in exchange for simply deciding on what you’re good at. The Game Master should keep a careful eye this. It’s most common in Prestige Class conversion.

Assistant (6 CP). Your “Aid Another” actions provides a +4 bonus, instead of the usual +2.

- *Aide* (+6 CP) You may add your +2 bonus to mystical and psionic actions by taking a similar action. For example, you could assist a more powerful spellcaster in casting a *Lightning Bolt*, adding either +2 Caster Levels, +2 to the save DC, +2 to the spell level, or +2 per die of damage, by casting *Shocking Grasp* as Aid Another.



Augmented Bonus (6 CP). You may add a second attribute bonus to the usual one in some specific situation, such as with a skill or set of linked skills, with a specified type of weapon, or against a type of foe.

- **Improved** (+6 CP) makes the attribute bonus apply in a fairly common situation. For example, saving throws occur regularly in most games. The Paladin has Improved Augmented Bonus for each saving throw, adding his or her Charisma bonus to his or her relevant saving throw bonus.

- **Advanced** (+6 CP) requires Improved and makes the attribute bonus apply in some very common or repetitive situation, such as to hit points or skill points per level.

- Adding a third attribute bonus to something *triples* the total cost of this ability!

- You may take this ability multiple times. Upgrades do not carry over. You may not take this more than twice for a single situation, and may not add the same ability bonus to one roll twice.

GM's normally want a good explanation for why you get to do this, and should refuse to allow this ability without one.

Augmented Magic (3 CP). This grants a +1 bonus on an aspect (usually Caster Level or damage per die) of a specific type of spell or under particular circumstances. For example, Wizards might take this bonus for Caster Level for their Illusion spells, or combat mages a damage bonus on fire-based spells of any school. Non-spellcasters may take this to augment specific effects, such as the damage from flame-based weapons.

- You may take this ability up to three times on any given power, but may only apply it once per aspect.

Awareness (6 CP). You suffer no defensive penalties when you're surprised. You retain your Dexterity bonus when caught flat-footed or attacked by an invisible assailant and save without penalty against surprises.

- **Flankless** (+6 CP). You can no longer be flanked. This is usually Specialized so that it does not function against opponents with a 4-level or better advantage over you.

- **Danger-Sense** (+1 CP) provides a +1 bonus on AC against trap attacks and on Reflex saves caused by traps. You may purchase this multiple times.

- **Defensive** (+3 CP) permits you to take a defensive action when surprised. You may take a Free Action and activate any abilities used solely to defend yourself (such as Expertise or Dodge), but not those which affect anyone else or affect your combat abilities in other ways.

- **Improved Defensive** (+3 CP) requires Defensive and permits you to take a Move-Equivalent Action when surprised.

- **Foresight** (+6 CP) requires Defensive and allows you to make a Wis check (DC at GMO; stealthy or quick enemies mean much harder DC's) to gain a chance to warn your friends, thus granting them the benefits of the Defensive ability described above.

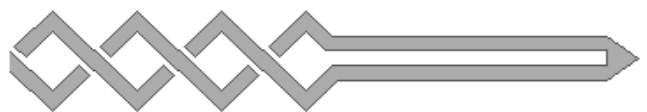
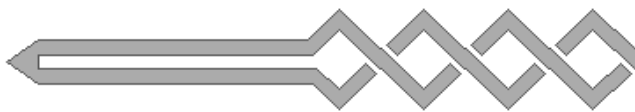


Look, I know you can build it, but I'm not putting up with a berserker squirrel and his mighty butterfly companions!

Berserker (6 CP). The Berserker ability grants extreme but short-lived bonuses. The user normally gains +4 to two attributes, +2 to a saving throw or AC, and -2 to another attribute, save, or AC for (3+Con Mod) rounds 1/day. The user gains another berserk session per day per 3 character levels or part thereof. The user becomes *fatigued* after using Berserker. GM's should note that the character may not generally do anything else but a specified, focused task or similar stunt. For the classic barbarian rage, the character can do little except immediate, physical skills and tasks, mostly meaning combat.

Note that the guidelines on where the bonuses should go are not meant as absolute rules; let a character pick something appropriate. AC, damage bonuses, to-hit bonuses, Caster Level, or even turning might all be acceptable choices depending on the character. The bonuses must simply total +8 (the character may apply a -2 penalty somewhere to add an additional +2).

Ability Level	Standard Barbarian Bonuses
Berserker	+4 Str, +4 Con, +2 Will, -2 AC
Odinpower	+6 Str, +6 Con, +3 Will, -2 AC
Odinmight	+8 Str, +8 Con, +4 Will, -2 AC



- **Controlled** (+6 CP) allows the user to make a DC 18 Will save to do something outside of his or her focus while berserk.
- **Odinpower** (+3 CP) usually increases the bonuses to +6, +6 and +3 respectively. The total increases to +13.
- **Odinmight** (+3 CP) requires Odinpower and usually increases the bonuses to +8, +8 and +4. The total increases to +18.
- **Enduring** (+3 CP) removes the *fatigue* after the berserker session. This is often combined with Corrupted Bonus Uses (only to extend the duration).
- You may take this ability multiple times. You may not use more than one Berserker effect at a time, and enhancements to one Berserker do not carry over. Each Berserker ability you buy can provide different bonuses.

Blessing (6 CP). Blessing allows you to give others abilities equal to your own. Although powerful and versatile, Blessing comes with built-in flaws: you can only bless others when your abilities exceed theirs, and you lose the difference. As an alternative, the user may opt to “share” a particular item slot and the benefits of whatever occupies it.

- For example, a character with Blessing and +8 BAB could give another character with +5 BAB the difference. His or her BAB would then fall to +5. The Blessing lasts for 24 hours without being renewed, and the “Blessor” may take back his or her abilities at any time. The Blessing ends if either dies.

While advanced upgrades do exist, allowing the user to bless groups of up to [Chr Mod +1] targets (+6 CP), to “share” more item slots (+6 CP each), to pass on a legacy after death (“Unique Training”, +6 CP), or allowing the user to “share” his or her successful saves or some other specific die check with those in the immediate vicinity (+12 CP), we recommend that these upgrades be left in the province of NPC’s or at least be carefully supervised. An elder mentor or other companion who can share some talent or protect his or her friends is a standard story element. A team made up of an ultimate melee master, ultimate offensive spellcaster, ultimate defender, ultimate stealth master, and ultimate manipulator all sharing their talents with each other is abusive, boring, and fabulously unlikely.

Blood Curse (6 CP). You may curse a single target, suppressing 12 CP worth of their abilities as they select. If the target dies, or if you triumph over them utterly in another way, you may select another target after a month has passed. If you die, nothing short of a special-purpose epic quest or divine action can nullify your curse.

Sadly, a good curse requires at least a month to work and must be directed at a precisely identified target (“the dark lord behind these attacks” is not good enough). Only the most powerful Blood Curse currently in effect on any given target counts. A peasant granny may curse the usurping demon prince, but she can’t simply get together a dozen friends and curse him into oblivion.

- **Blood Tide** (+6 CP) lets you upgrade your curse. You may suppress up to 18 CP worth of your own abilities (or spare CP) to suppress twice as many CP worth of your target’s abilities. Your suppressed abilities will return a month after your target is slain or otherwise completely defeated.

- **Bane** (+6 CP) lets you add a specific Disadvantage (page 18) as a part of the effects of your curse.

- **Doom** (+6 CP) lets you select the abilities to be suppressed rather than allowing the target to do so.

- **Malediction** (+6 CP) lets you curse an additional (Cha Mod, 1 Minimum) targets. If you’re using Blood Tide your suppressed abilities will not return while any curses powered by them remain active.

Blood Curse is not a very good investment for most people - but it is very classic, the odd vengeful character might want it, and it is very simple in this system. It fits some campaigns better than others, particularly when the Witchcraft rules are in play.

Body Fuel (6 CP). Body Fuel enables you to transmute your own health into power. Every 2 points of temporary attribute damage yields 2 Power, 1 Spell Level, or 1/2 of a Mana point. Characters may allocate spell levels to spells prepared and already cast without resting, but cannot exceed their usual spell level limits. Any attribute points expended on Body Fuel cannot be regained by psionic or magical means short of a *Limited Wish*, which translates the drain into an XP point loss as listed under Versatile, below.

- **Efficient** (+6 CP) doubles your yield from Body Fuel. Characters may take this multiple times to triple or even quadruple the yield.

- **Versatile** (+6 CP) allows you to use 4 hit points or (with GM permission) 50 experience points as 1 attribute point for this feat. It may be possible to burn off other types of points as well, but this will require permission from the Game Master.

- **Reserve** (+6 CP) provides 6 “phantom” attribute points to use for Body Fuel only. This may be taken up to three times and, for +6 CP, may be expanded so as to be able to divert other forms of attribute damage to this reserve.

- **Kundalini** (+6 CP) allows magical or psionic effects powered by or with the assistance of Body Fuel to ignore antimagic and anti-psionic effects. If the effect was personalized (*i.e.*, affects you only) it ignores dispel effects as well.

While Kundalini can be a very powerful effect, it isn’t actually useful very often. Few powerful characters are willing to work in an antimagic field anyway. It’s a great way to let one character assault that megavillain - presuming that he or she doesn’t have it, too.

- **Blood Magic** (+6 CP) allows the user to use the energy from Body Fuel to spontaneously add levels of any metamagic he or she knows to an effect, up to a limit of +4 spell levels over his or her usual limits. This may be taken twice, increasing the limit to +6, or three times, increasing the limit to +7, the absolute maximum.

Celerity (6 CP). Celerity adds +10 feet per round to one of your movement modes. This is considered bonus movement for the purposes of skills; it does not apply when calculating movement penalties on skill use.

- **Improved** adds +10' more movement per 3 CP invested.

- **Stunt Double** (+6 CP) allows brief water walking, running down cliffs, and similar wild actions provided that you have a movement rate of at least 60'.

- **Additional** (+12 CP) allows you to use Celerity to add a new movement mode, such as Flight or Burrowing. A creature with a movement mode enjoys a +8 bonus on checks for using that movement mode and has a base movement rate of 20' (Flight or Ground), 10' (Swim), or 0' (Burrow). Once again, the Game Master is likely to keep a careful eye on this.

Cloaking (6 CP). A character with Cloaking has an always-on disguise over his or her mystical and/or psychic aura, although this has no effect on normal senses. You must specify what the effect is. Cloaking is often used to make one look like a honest fellow to fool truth-detection, to alter your apparent alignment, or to disguise yourself as a member of a similar species.

- For example, Davin the Diviner searches for the human rogue Clara. But Clara has Cloaking to make her look like an elf to divination magic. Davin passes her over in his search without a second thought.

- **Variable** (+6 CP) allows you to alter the effect of your disguise, although not what is disguised. If you can cloak your alignment, Variable lets you appear to be of any alignment you want - but it won't conceal whether or not you're lying. If you can conceal lies, this lets you make things look like lies, truths, or half-truths at will, but

won't conceal your species.

- **Contact** (+3 CP) allows you to use your personal cloak on anyone you touch at the same time.

- **Area** (+6 CP) requires Contact and cloaks the entire area around the character, making it difficult to locate who, exactly, possesses the disguised aura.

Companion (6 CP). Used to gain familiars, psi-crystals, animal companions, and sometimes mounts. Companion empowers a sidekick - usually an animal. You may choose to apply the standard d20 Druid's Animal Companion bonuses, Wizard's Familiar bonuses, Paladin's Mount bonuses, get a Psi-Crystal, or use any similar progression. The base creature may not have an ECL of more than 1/3 your character level.

- **Template** (+6 CP) adds a template of up to +2 ECL to the companion. Only one Template can be applied to a given companion, but you may pay the cost multiple times to add a more powerful template. The ECL addition is cumulative up to a maximum of +6.

- **Storage** (+6 CP) allows you to store a number of spell levels in the Companion equal to the Companion's Charisma. You may release the spells as if you were using a scroll, provided your Companion is touching or adjacent to you. For an additional +6 CP you or the companion may release a spell as if using a spell storing device.

- **Great Form** (+6 CP) allows you to apply *Righteous Might* (at a Caster Level equal to your level) to a companion as a Free Action up to three times per day.

- **Might** (+6 CP) allows you to grant your companion the benefits of two Positive Levels (see page 86) or of a continuously active second level spell or psychic effect.

- **Transform** (+6 CP) allows you to take a form similar to your Companion's, and the Companion to take a form of your species. You both need not use this ability at the same time, but may if you wish.

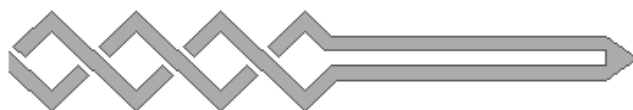
- **Transference** (+Sp.) allows you to give CP to your Companion. He, she, or it receives 2 CP for every 1 CP you surrender.

- **Additional** (+6 CP) allows you to gain another Companion. The new Companion gains the benefits of any Great Form, Might, Storage, Transform, or Template bonuses already given to a previous Companion, if applicable and you so desire.

If you want a normally-sentient sidekick, take the Leadership ability instead.



A Horse! A Horse? My Kingdom for a booster seat!



Contacts (1 CP each). Contacts are simply (reasonably) reliable individuals in particular businesses, or with a particular set of skills, which the character knows. For example, a character might know a reliable fence, a poison merchant, a skillful alchemist, and an expert appraiser. Another might know a wise old priest, a good scribe, and a translator of rare languages and inscriptions. A contact can be discarded and replaced (or regained later) in 1d4 weeks.

- **Multiple** (+6 CP) lets you multiply the number of contacts you get for each CP invested by (Cha Mod + 1).
- **Occult** (+1 CP) grants a Contact with very powerful or very strange abilities. This may be taken twice on a particular contact, in which case it may be an entity, such as a ghost, outsider, fey, monster, or other unusual being rather than an ordinary character type.
- **Well-Traveled** (+3 CP) lets you locate new or old contacts in an area in only 1d4 days rather than 1d4 weeks.

Countermagic (6 CP). With Countermagic you may:

- Counterspell with any spell of the same school of higher level than the target effect.
- Use *Dispel Magic* and *Greater Dispel Magic* with a +5 bonus on the roll.
- Use an unused empty spell slot of level 3+ like a normal *Dispel Magic*.
- **Empty Mind** (+6 CP) allows you to use your unused spell slots as specific counterspells, guaranteeing success.
- **Reflexive** (+6 CP) allows you to reflexively use any Countermagic technique. This is actually an example of the Reflex Training feat (page 40), but requires the basic Countermagic feat.
- **The Spiral Dance** (+12 CP) allows you to seize control of a successfully-counterspelled spell, rather than simply negating it. You may redirect the spell, even back upon the original caster.

Costly (12 CP). Costly makes it harder to affect you with mystical abilities of some type (typically Arcane magic, Psionics, Thaumaturgy and Dweomer, Witchcraft, or Divine magic).

- Magical effects cost 1 extra spell level to affect you properly. The spell still functions either way, but if the caster does not spend the extra level (they can sacrifice any available spell level or generic levels), the magical effect is weakened, lowering the required saving throw DC (if any) and effective Caster Level by -1.
- Psionic and Witchcraft abilities require 2 extra Power (easier to get than spare spell levels), but if the user cannot pay, they are simply drained of all remaining Power and the effect fails.

- **Improved** (+12 CP) increases the extra cost to 2 spell levels or 4 Power.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it affects another type of mystical ability.

Create Artifact (6 CP) You may create magical items the old-fashioned way, with bizarre mystic ingredients, strange rituals, and guesswork. While very powerful, and supremely flexible, this is laborious, dangerous, and unreliable, which is why modern methods supplanted it. Occasional adventurers, whether in search of supreme power, or simply because they prefer the quests and mysticism of such creations to spending time and effort to learn modern methods, still study such antiquities.

As an example, Fymbulwyntyr, the Wand of the Winter's Breath, is a carved white dragon's tooth. The would-be creator must submerge it for seven days in a pool of unfreezing water at the North Pole, have it blessed and enruned by an Ice Hag, and only handle it with gloves of Yeti hide until activating it by solving the riddle of the Icy King. On the other hand, it holds up to 90 charges and casts Ice Storm, Extinguish Flames, and Wall of Ice (at 1 charge each), Cone of Cold and Wall of Ice (at 2 charges each), and Control Weather that summons cold and winter storms only (at 3 charges). It may or may not negate fire-based attacks on contact for an appropriate number of charges, depending on how well

the maker paid the Ice Hag. Wielders can recharge it by simply throwing cold-based spells at it. There is no XP or GP cost, although accomplishing the necessary tasks may take quite a lot of gold. The casting level and the spells used in the creation process, if any, are specified by the GM. If you make a mistake in the procedure, the results become unpredictable. Small variations suffice to ensure that no two artifacts are ever identical, so characters can't mass-produce them. The Game Master should make sure that they're worth the trouble.

In practice, the player outlines the item and general procedure, the Game Master makes whatever modifications he feels appropriate, and the character first researches the procedure and then undertakes it.

- Characters who want to know a specific item-creation "recipe" may acquire it for 1 SP. Optionally, the Game Master may choose to use this as the general method for creating items. If you want to make an item you'll need to either develop the lore on your own (e.g., spend that CP or skill point), locate a manual or directions for it (a reason to go adventuring), or locate an NPC who knows the secret techniques.



Create Item (6 CP). You may create magical or psionic items of some sort. Choose a standard item slot or item type (Arms and Armor count as a single item type in most worlds) or some other grouping, such as Traps, Constructs, or Runes, items related to a particular field of magic, such as fire or transformation, or items related to a particular profession or occupation.

GM's should be restrictive about item categories.

- **Accelerated** (Special.) allows you to shorten the time taken to craft an item. Divide the normal duration in days by the number of CP paid into Accelerated. You may upgrade this ability as often as you wish.

- **Additional** (+6 CP) gives you a bonus item slot. Provided that it's physically practical, the user can wear one extra magic item and have it work. For example, he or she could wear a headband and spectacles or an extra ring. This is often Specialized in particular item slots, such as "rings."

- **Artificer** (+6/12/24 CP) reduces the GP or the XP cost for making items by 25%/50%/75%. This talent is commonly Specialized, but you can't get Double Effect.

- **Artisan** (+6 CP) allows you to half the XP cost of an enchantment by doubling the GP cost or vice-versa. At the GM's option this may be automatic (half GP and double XP) on Tattoo Magic/Creature Enchantments. As an alternative, the item may be assigned unpleasant or dangerous side effects rather than doubling a cost.

- **Transference** (+6 CP) allows you to accept freely-donated experience points for making magical items instead of supplying them all yourself, although you cannot use such donated points for any other purpose. You can also put spirits into items to power them; this provides the equivalent of (200 x creature's CR) XP. As a rule, spirits are only willing if the binding is for a limited time. For an additional +6 CP you may bind unwilling spirits or drain XP from unwilling victims. Unfortunately, items created in this fashion are invariably cursed in some fashion. Secondarily, binding spirits into items often upsets more powerful entities.

- **Epic** (+12 CP, minimum character level 20) lets you create items up to twice as powerful as normal ones. Multiply the base GP cost by 10 for making such items.

- **Excellence** (+3 CP) lets you add your full attribute bonus to the DC of resisting an item's functions rather than the minimum bonus required to cast the spell.

- **Harvest of Artifice** (+6 CP) lets you gather and expend up to 100 XP (+50 per additional +3 CP) per month on item creation or Transmutations (below) at no personal cost. You cannot add these points to your personal total, accumulate them from month to month, or use them for other purposes.

- **Alchemic Mastery** (+3 CP) lets you distill XP (whether personal, donated or harvested) into alchemical mixtures. These function as universal power components, storing those XP for later use by anyone in making items, transmuting, or in casting spells with XP components. Unfortunately, it costs 2 XP to store 1 and the stored points cannot be used for other purposes.

- **Transmutation** (+6 CP) lets you infuse XP into material to transmute it into more useful mundane forms. This costs 1 XP per 2 GP worth of equipment so produced. We recommend that this be limited to transmutations within the same general type of elemental material and that "labor costs" be considered for things like opening pits.

- **Philosopher's Stone** (+6 CP, requires both Alchemic Mastery and Transmutation) allows you to store both a transmutation effect and the XP to power it in an alchemical talisman, to be used at the whim of the possessor. The user need not have any special abilities.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, you gain another kind of item creation ability. Upgrades apply to all of them. In fact, they can also be applied to any **Spell Storing** abilities (page 98) you happen to have.

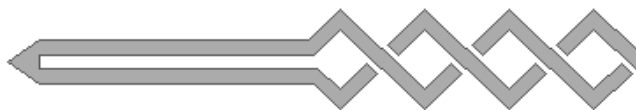
Create Relic (6 CP). Another classical way to create weird and wonderful devices, Create Relic allows you to invest CP directly into items. Each 1 CP permanently invested in such an item grants it 6 CP worth of abilities to bestow on the user. While this is permanently weakens you, and creates items which are intimately tied to you, it does allow the creation of truly impressive devices without having to expend a lot of CP on special abilities. Such items are very good links to you for certain magical activities.

*Relics can come into being quite accidentally. Gods with the **Divine Infusion** ability often find themselves endowed with relics, while magical disasters, heroic deaths and final blessings/legacies sometimes begin the process spontaneously. One relatively "common" relic type simply includes an advanced version of the skills needed to enchant it further, allowing its wielder to invest his or her own CP, XP and wealth in doing so. Typically 1-2 points invested is sufficient since such abilities are - obviously enough - quite Specialized.*

Game Masters should beware of players who want to invest large amounts of CP in relics - although it usually suffices to remind them that toys can be taken away. Similarly, a group of characters who all want to create relics to pass around the group are in search of a firm "No" or an ECL penalty.

Damage Reduction. DR comes rated at 2/3/4/5/6/8/10/12/15/20/25/30/35 points at a cost of 3/6/9/12/15/24/36/45/60/75/96/120/150 CP. This applies to all damage sources, including magical and energy-based attacks. Characters commonly specialize it by applying it only towards physical attacks, energy attacks, magical attacks, or another GM-approved specialty. The Corrupted modifier can be added by leaving an additional common "hole" in your defenses. For example, silver weaponry or fire spells would apply to physical reduction or magic defenses, respectively.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, you add another type of damage reduction.



Deep Sleep (6 CP). Many ascetics study meditation and mysticism. In d20, these skills are as useful as any. With Deep Sleep, a character gains the benefits of a full night's rest in only four hours and may ignore minor (up to 15 minutes total) interruptions in that interval.

- **Meditation** (+6 CP) allows a character to regain his or her spells or Power whenever he or she has enough time to rest. At the very utmost, this can only work three times per day, and even arranging that is usually quite difficult.

- **Self Healing** (+3 CP) allows the character to enter a healing trance, doubling his or her normal healing rate. In addition, the character recovers 2 attribute points from temporary attribute damage every day.

- **Cosmic Awareness** (+6 CP), allows the user to gain mysterious insights into the universe with a successful Wis check, obtaining obscure prophecies, strange clues, odd riddles, a glimpse of the obvious, some good advice, or whatever other information the Game Master feels like giving out today. The GM sets the DC for deliberate use, which increases by +5 per usage in a day.

Of course, this also helps get the party back on track when they get lost.

- **True Prophet** (+6 CP), requires *Cosmic Awareness*. You may shape destiny. Your words WILL come to pass barring intervention by a deity or similar power. Your pronouncements must, however, be either vague and open-ended ("Disaster and misfortune shall follow you all the days of your life!"), contain an either-or escape hatch ("Either all the clans shall be united or all shall fall!"), or be of very limited scope and fairly immediate effect ("Don't worry Madam! We WILL find your child before he freezes to death!"). The GM must rule on the acceptability of a prophecy before the user pronounces it; this may reveal information (e.g., if the kid's already dead no meaningful prophecy can be made about finding him alive) otherwise unavailable, but does not count as a use of this ability. The GM must pre-approve this ability, since he or she has to work with the player to produce interesting and appropriate prophecies. Always remember; prophecies can be distinctly double-edged. This ability may be used for both major (once per session or game month, whichever is longer) and minor (up to three times per session) prophecies.

- **Body Control** (+6 CP) allows the character to reduce his or her need for sleep, oxygen, food, and water to one quarter normal, or to resist poisons, with a successful Wis (DC 15) check. Unfortunately, this requires sinking into a meditative trance. Acting while maintaining such a state requires the use of 1 Power or 1/4th point of Mana per round.

- **Stasis** (+3 CP) requires *Body Control* and enables the character to make a Wis check (DC 15) to enter stasis. The character needs no air, food, drink, or rest, and does not suffer from poisons, but cannot move or take any physical actions. The character does not age in this state.



Are you sure you want a character who specializes in sleeping?

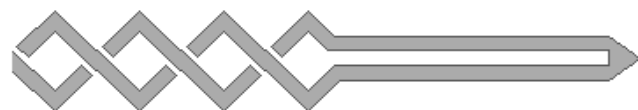
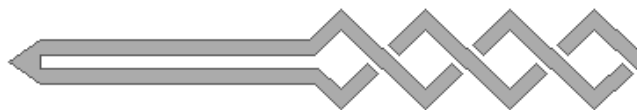
Device Use (6 CP). You may select a type of racial or professional item you cannot currently use. From now on you may use it as if you possessed the required class, race, sex, or other relevant characteristic.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it adds another effective characteristic.

Domain/Path (6 CP). You gain access to either a set of thematically linked spells or to a versatile "metaspell" which can be cast at various levels to produce effects within its theme. The domain, path, or metaspell selected or created is subject to the approval of the Game Master. Domains and paths usually include nine spells; one of each of the usual spell levels. They do not include any special domain powers: these must be purchased separately.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it adds another domain or path.

Metaspells can be cast at various levels to produce effects within their narrow themes. For example, *Weave of the Spider King* creates strands and cords of silk, stickyness optional. Simple enough. On the other hand, with a little imagination it can be used to weave nets, hurl ropes, wrap up enemies, create clothing, and bridge chasms. In game terms, a metaspell's caster defines the effect he or she is trying to produce and the GM rules on whether or not it (a) fits the nature of the spell being used, (b) is within the limits of the skills and knowledge



of the caster, (c) whether or not a check of some sort will be required (very common if or when the caster is pushing it), and (d) what the spell level will be. Fortunately, most casters soon develop a repertoire of more-or-less “standardized” applications, reducing the GM’s workload. A broad selection of metaspells is included in our first work, *Legends of High Fantasy*.

Dominion (6 CP). With Dominion, a character may draw power from those who acknowledge his or her leadership. With the GM’s permission he or she may take the Dominion paths, presented on page 72, with the GM’s permission.

Dweomer (6+ CP). This alternative magic system is based on groups of related magical skills. See page 100.

Eldritch (0 CP). You may call upon exotic forces to power your magic rather than relying on the usual sources. In other words, your magic may have strange special effects for free. This has no direct game effect, but gives you more style. Eldritch abilities that cost spell levels do not extend the casting time.

- **Subtle** (+6 CP) your magic is hard to detect once cast; even characters using Detect Magic or similar effects must make a Will save (DC 10 + caster’s spellcasting attribute modifier + spell level) to notice your magic.
- **Enduring** (+6 CP) makes your spells difficult to counterspell. Enemies must make a Dispel Check to counterspell them even if they would normally not need to. Enduring costs +1 spell level like a metamagic feat, unless the character also applies the same penalty to his or her attempts to counter other’s magic.
- **Tenacious** (+6 CP) adds +5 to other’s check DC to counter the caster’s spells. Tenacious costs +1 spell level like a metamagic feat, unless the character also applies the same penalty to his or her ability to counter other’s magic.
- Characters using advanced Eldritch feats must select and describe the source of their powers. Other characters with the Eldritch feat and the same source receive no penalties or advantages when facing the user.
- All three effects may be taken as a set for only 6 CP, but this cannot then be “turned off.” It also limits use of magic items to items made by a character with at least one of these modifiers. Many settings have spells usable only with Eldritch magic, and others not usable at all with Eldritch magic.

Empowerment (6 CP). You may link your own energies with those of a charged or uses-per-day magic item in your possession up to (3+Int Mod) times per day. The item uses the highest of its or your attribute modifiers and Casting Level. The spell levels, psionic Power, and other components for the effect come from the item or from you as desired. XP costs are always borne by you. You may Specialize in a particular type of device. In this case, waive the times-per-day usage limit.

If you apply this variant to Siddhis yoga talents (page 44), the effects you wish to enhance must have a particular theme. You cannot simply apply it to all of your talents.

Enthusiast (3 CP). Enthusiast grants 1 floating CP. Given 72 hours to retrain and redirect it you may put it into anything you please save for Specific Knowledges (page 10), boosting that ability until you turn your enthusiasm in another direction.

- **Double** (+3 CP) upgrades Enthusiast so that it grants 2 floating CP instead of 1.
- **Adaption** (+3 CP) allows the user to redirect a CP in a mere 1d4+1 hours.

This is very useful when Specialized in languages - or in the creation of minor relics.

Equipage (6 CP). A character with Equipage can always find minor items (with a maximum value of 2/5/10 GP per level per week for 6/12/18 CP) on his or her person. It does not matter if the character is locked naked in a dimensional vault; he or she can *always* locate the required goods. Sadly, all versions of Equipage are limited to things that the user can reasonably carry; normal humans cannot pull five tons of dirt out of their back pocket just because it’s cheap.

- **Link** (+3 CP) allows the user to bond with a specific item currently in his or her possession. From then on, the user may pull it out of nowhere on a moment’s notice.
- **Purchasing** (+6 CP) allows the character to stuff money into his or her pockets and pull out gear in exchange. Availability is up to the GM, who may require Gather Information rolls or a similar check for exotic items.
- **Returns** allows the character to put items into his or her pockets to build “credit” for later purchasing. This grants 50%/80%/90% of the item’s value for +3/6/12 CP). While most useful with Purchasing, this does work with the basic version.
- **Signature** (+6 CP) lets the character instantly equip himself or herself with an equipment package (designed when this ability is taken) worth up to 12,000 GP. This may include mounts and permanent magic items, but not expendable ones, and lasts for 12,000/(GP value of package) minutes. Consumables, such rations or rope, will not disappear once used, but the character can only replace them at a rate of 5 GP worth of material per week. Characters may call on their signature packages up to (Level/3 +1) times daily.

Executive (6 CP). Executives grant skill bonuses to groups working on tasks. As long as those involved are cooperating to achieve some end and are willing to listen to the character they receive a +(Executive’s level/2) cooperation bonus to relevant skill rolls. Executives can normally lead a maximum of (Charisma) individuals at one time, cannot do anything but issue orders while providing this bonus, and cannot provide a bonus greater than twice the number of people in the group.

- **CEO** (+6 CP). You may provide bonuses for up to (5 x Charisma) individuals at one time. This may be taken up to three times, increasing the number to x25 and x125 respectively, but x125 is the upper limit.
- **Tactician** (+6 CP). You may command troops in battle, providing bonuses of +(your level/4) to attack rolls and damage, as well as the usual bonus to skills.
- An Executive can only help people who aren't interested in helping themselves so far. He or she can only help a number of unwilling or grudging people equal to the number of willing followers.



Well, SOMEBODY has to be in charge!

Expertise (6 CP). A character with Expertise selects two related abilities, attributes, or other scores. He or she may reduce one of the selected abilities' bonuses at any time by up to -5 to add a equal amount to the other bonus. Usually, characters take this for Warcraft (BAB) and AC or damage, but many other combinations exist.

- **Improved Expertise** (+6 CP) increases the upper limit to + and -20.

Favors (3 CP). Characters with favors have connections with a specified major group *or* with up to (Cha Mod + 3) notable individuals and can call on minor favors once in a while (usually once per game session). While vastly powerful contacts are possible, they're not recommended, at least to start with. Contacts sometimes ask for favors in return - and those are always about *their* big problems. While favors shouldn't dominate the game, they can still be quite important.

- **Major** (+3 CP) favors let you call on your contacts for bigger things; you may get an actual prototype instead of some information on its specifications, a letter of introduction rather than a casual contact at a party, or get something wiped off the record rather than getting it overlooked.
- **Enormous** (+6 CP) favors require Major favors first. You might be able to get someone into a witness relocation program, get a raid launched, or get a set of records inserted to back up a phony ID.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time it adds a new set of contacts with their own favor rating.

Finesse (6 CP). A character with Finesse may replace one attribute modifier with another in some fairly common situation, such as for a particular saving throw.

- **Advanced** (+6 CP) makes the attribute bonus apply in some very common or repetitive situation, such as to hit points or skill points per level.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it affects another situation. Upgrades do not carry over.

GM's normally want a good explanation for why you get to do this, and are likely to refuse to allow this ability without one. This is especially true of the advanced version.

Grant of Aid (6 CP). You are automatically healed of 1d8+5 points of damage *or* 1d3 points of attribute damage *or* 1 negative level (select as needed) once per day per three levels or part thereof. This does not require an action; the player simply decides when it happens.

- **Mighty** (+3 CP) adds the character's (Con Mod) to the amount of HP damage healed and +1 to either of the other options.
- **Regenerative** (+3 CP) allows either slow (1d4 weeks) regrowth of lost limbs and organs *or* the rapid re-attachment of any bits that get chopped off. Regenerative may be taken twice to get both effects.
- **Spark of Life** (+6 CP) allows the user to cling to life, and heal or be healed normally, for (Con score x 5) rounds after he or she ought to be dead unless driven below (- Total hit points). This doesn't work with Stoic: Ferocity (page 45); you'll still lose consciousness once you ought to be dead.
- Fast Healing is usually purchased using Specialized (HP only, double effect) and Corrupted (slow, may or may not work [GMO] versus tissue-destroying effects such as fire and acid, x1.5 effect) modifiers, for a base of 1d8+5 (usually taken as 10) points per level per day.

This illustrates a notable point: very few abilities are actually "unlimited." We usually take creature listings with "unlimited" use of particular abilities to simply mean "enough that the GM doesn't have to worry about it during an encounter." Player characters are another matter; they have to pay for their abilities.

Guises (3 CP). Guises allows a character to create an alternate identity, complete with whatever documents, references, legal history, or acquaintances might be necessary. This identity must be of the character's species (and often ethnicity) but may have a different public face or personality. Creating such an identity takes a minimum of several weeks.

- *Many* allows the character to create up to two more identities per +3 CP invested. The character need not create them all at once.
- *Racial* (+3 CP) allows the character to appear as per a foreign ethnicity or species the character is similar to. Be reasonable. A human could probably pass for an elf with a little cosmetic help, but not a dragon.
- *Quick Change* (+6 CP) allows the character to change Guises or merely use the Disguise skill with a flourish of a cape or any other Move-Equivalent Action.
- *Cultural Adaptation* (+6 CP) allows the character to blend into other cultures as if he or she were a native, as long as he or she has a relevant persona.
- *Mental Guise* (+6 CP) makes the personas "real." Even truth-detecting magic below 7th level will not reveal the deception.
- *Split Persona* (+6 CP) requires Mental Guise and allows the character to shift around up to 10% of his or her skill points in each persona he or she has. The character actually loses points from his or her "real" skills while pretending to be someone else.

Harnessed Intellect (6 CP). With this ability a character may sustain a spell or other power that normally requires concentration for (Int Mod + 1) rounds without concentrating, although he or she cannot control the effect exactly during this period. The effect continues doing whatever it was doing before. The user may take control again when time runs out. This ability may be employed once per minute.

Healing Touch (6 CP). Healing Touch allows characters to heal themselves or another by touch for ([Cha Mod] x [character level]) points per day. The healing may be split up rather than used all at once.

- *Improved* (+6 CP) adds (character level/3) uses per week of one of the following: *Remove Disease*, *Lesser Restoration*, *Remove Blindness/Deafness*, *Cure Serious Wounds*, or *Remove Curse*. The character chooses which spell effect can be used when he or she gains Improved.
- *Switch* (+6 CP) requires *Improved* and allows the character to mimic any of the above spells as needed.
- *Empower* (+6 CP) requires *Switch* and adds *Neutralize Poison* and *Restoration* to the list.

The Accursed Touch variant simply uses the reversed forms of most of the spells, substituting Vampiric Touch for Lesser Restoration and Enervation for Restoration.

Many village healers and priests rely almost entirely on Healing Touch. With Bonus Uses and an augmented Charisma bonus it suffices for almost any local need.

Hysteria (6 CP). Similar to Berserker, Hysteria lets the user briefly expand his or her own abilities. This costs 4 Power or 1 Mana, and grants a +6 bonus to a save, Caster Level, turning intensity, AC, skill or attribute check, or similar trait. While the specific bonus is selected by the user when he or she activates the ability, he or she must select a theme (magical, physical, or mental) when he or she purchases the feat and must choose bonuses in keeping with the theme. This activates as a Free Action and lasts for 1 round.

- *Warding* (+6 CP) allows the user to shrug off an ability-draining attack with a use of Hysteria. The GM may allow the character to shrug off other special attacks appropriate to his or her theme, but may opt to charge an additional +3 CP for the privilege.
- *Extended* (+6 CP) lets the user pay twice the normal cost (8 Power or 2 mana), but extends the duration to one minute.
- *Great* (+6 CP) halves the cost of using Hysteria, usually to 2 Power or 1 mana.
- *Mighty* (+6 CP) lets the user invoke Hysteria to double the effect of a spell, attack, or ability. This doubles the Power or Mana cost of Hysteria and supersedes the normal +6 bonus.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, you add another form of Hysteria. You may not stack Hysteria with itself, although you can combine it with Berserker if you can justify it to your Game Master.

Inherent Spell (6 CP). A character with this ability possesses a natural spell or psychic power of up to level 3. It's usable once per day if it's level 3, twice per day if it's level 2, and includes two different spells usable twice per day each if they're level 1. These spell-like abilities are cast as if by a Sorcerer or Psion of the character's level. Inherent spells generally have a minimum level requirement of ([Spell Level x 2] -1), but the Game Master may opt to allow exceptions for very low-level characters and/or non-combative inherent spells. A first level character with *Scrying* is much less of a problem than one with *Fireball* in most games.

- *Multiple* adds +1/2/3/4 uses per day for +3/4/5/6 CP. If this is applied to a pair of L1 effects it increases the uses per day of both.
- *Advanced* adds a related (GMO) spell or power of level (3 + the number of times Advanced has been taken so far) to the character's repertoire. Grades 1 to 3 cost +6 CP each, grades 4 and 5 cost +12 CP each, and grade 6 (for an inherent ninth level spell) costs +18 CP. Each spell is usable once per day as a base, but the number of uses may be increased normally. XP and other special costs remain unchanged.
- *Internal* (+6 CP) changes the ability from spell-like to supernatural or possibly even extraordinary if the Game Master feels that this is reasonable.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Upgrades do not carry over; each base ability begins its own sequence of related abilities.

Immunity. Immunity helps protect a character from some specified effect, environment, or attack. While most often taken for some type of energy attack, it might apply to anything the character can dream up. The cost is calculated from what, specifically, the character is warding against.

- How common is the attack or effect? *Uncommon* effects like “spider venom” or “hard radiation” set the base price at 3 CP. *Common* effects include specific types of elemental damage, like Fire or Electricity, specific types of magic such as Divination or Illusion, and dangers such as poison or falling. Common effects set the base price at 6 CP. *Very Common* effects would include effects like “weapon damage” and set the base price at 12 CP - if the Game Master allows them at all.

- How severe are the effects of whatever-it-is? *Minor* effects such as “Charm” or “Fear,” pain, most weather, truth detection and other divinations, or any other inconvenience, cost nothing extra. *Major* effects, such as damage, paralysis, and level drain cost +3 CP. *Severe* effects such as transformation, death, full mind control, being incarcerated, or anything else that pretty much takes the character out of play, cost +6 CP.

- The amount of resistance the character purchases changes the price. *Trivial* resistance (5 points of damage or effects of up to spell level 1) costs 1/3 the cost calculated above. *Minor* resistance (12 points or effects of up to level 3) costs 2/3 the price calculated above. *Major* resistance (30 points or effects of up to L5) costs the full amount calculated above. *Great* resistance (60 points or effects of up to L7) costs twice the base price. *Epic* resistance (90 points or effects of up to L9) costs three times the base price. Finally, *Legendary* resistance (100 points and reduce any remaining damage by 75% or effects of L20 or less including “Epic” spells and powers) costs four times the base price.

- If resistances don’t fit, add typeless bonuses to the relevant rolls instead. Trivial adds +2, Minor +4, Major +6, and Legendary +8. Immunity is versatile, and sometimes the GM may have to judge the amount of resistance.

For example, the Improved Precise Shot feat from the 3.5 edition allows the character to evade all cover penalties below total cover or concealment, including grapples. This is a Major effect. If it allowed the character to ignore even total cover or concealment, it would become Legendary.

- Immunity also allows characters to bypass special defenses. Simply take an Immunity to the defense in question. This usually requires Major Resistance, unless it would be easy (Minor) or very easy (Trivial) to bypass the defense through other means.

- Characters may take immunity to aspects of reality if the Game Master opts to allow it. For example, a super-strong character might take Immunity to Leverage and be able to pick up clumsy objects or carry heavy ones without putting stress on the floor. Dimensional travelers may opt to take an immunity to local conditions, so that

they can keep their abilities and equipment working in realms that wouldn’t ordinarily allow them, although this is often Corrupted to require a roll. Immunity to range penalties is always very popular, but Game Masters are advised to keep a careful eye on such purchases.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, you add another type of Immunity.



Immunity: Cheesecake

Innate Enchantment (6 CP). With Innate Enchantment, a character has two options:

- His or her innate power may duplicate the effects of a magical item or items valued at up to 5000 GP (according to the standard d20 rules). The character must pay twice the normal experience point cost to create said item. For every +1 additional CP invested, these innate enchantments rise in value by 1000 GP.

- *Absorption*, a variant form, has no upper value limit – but the user must have the item to be absorbed. The item is effectively destroyed, although theoretically a sufficiently powerful spell or effect might reclaim it from the character’s body or corpse. For an additional +6 CP you may change the bonuses, if any, granted by an absorbed item to another type. Perhaps fortunately, the choice of type is permanent even if you buy the Innate Enchantment/Absorption ability again.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time you gain a new inherent enchantment or can absorb an additional item.

Innate Magic (6 CP). Innate Magic converts a spell slot to a permanent supernatural (for spells which affect the user only) or spell-like ability useable 2/4/7/12/18/24/36/60/Unlimited times daily for slots of 0/1/2/3/4/5/6/7/8-9 levels above that of the desired effect. The spell used must be one that the character could normally cast.

For example, Egrith the Thunderer could give up a fifth-level slot to gain Lightning Bolt as a spell-like ability usable seven times per day. If he restricted Fly so that it only worked on him, he could take it as a supernatural ability. If he wants to continue casting Fly on other people, it would be spell-like.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time it converts an additional spell slot.

Invocation (6 CP). Invocation grants one bonus spell slot usable for any spell or power you can cast up to your current spell level limit in a particular progression. This goes up with the character, so it never becomes obsolete.

- **Thematic** (+6 CP) allows the bonus spell slot to be used to spontaneously cast any spell within a chosen theme, domain, or path that's currently within your abilities otherwise. This may be considered Specialized if the slot is not usable otherwise.

- **Improved Thematic** (+3 CP) requires Thematic and makes a slot with Thematic even more versatile. Even if a character prepares a spell in the slot it can still be used for spontaneous spellcasting within the theme.

- **Split** (+3 CP) allows the spell slot to be broken up into individual spell levels and allocated out as needed, either spontaneously or prepared.

- **Doubled** (+6 CP) requires Split. This doubles the number of spell levels in the pool created by Split but does not increase the maximum spell level.

- **Mighty** (+6 CP) makes the bonus spell slot one level higher than your previous maximum. This stacks with itself, allowing the purchase of successively higher-level slots with each purchase of Invocation (12 CP total). Sadly, using an spell slot of level (N) still requires a minimum Caster Level of (2N-1) and a casting attribute of (10 + N).

- You may take this ability multiple times. Upgrades do not carry over.

Jack-of-All-Trades (6 CP). Jacks-of-All-Trades gain +1 bonus to all skill checks based on an attribute selected when this ability is taken.

- **Greater** (+6 CP) increases the bonus to +2.
- **Universal** (+6 CP) gives the user an effective rank of 1 in any unrestricted skill. This does not decrease the cost of actually buying the skill.

Journeyman (6 CP). A Journeyman may purchase some type of ability (often skills or spellcasting) as if he or she were one level higher, increasing the usual (Level + 3) cap.

- **Master** (+6 CP). You may buy abilities of the chosen type as if you were two levels higher.

- **Grand Master** (+12 CP, requires Master). You may buy abilities of the chosen type as if you were three levels higher.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it affects another ability.

Karma (6 CP). One a character takes the Karma feat, he or she gains the attention of cosmic forces. The user may gain and spend "Karma" points. One point of "Good Karma" comes free with the feat.

- Characters may only accumulate 5 total Karma points. Spending one gets the user a +10 synergy bonus to all die rolls except damage for the next round.

- The character adds +1 Good Karma per level gained, +1 per act of dramatic heroism, or +1 per CP spent.

- The character adds +1 point of "Bad Karma" per act of gross villainy and evil. Bad Karma works just as well as Good Karma for the user, but the Game Master then gets to inflict random havoc on the character's allies. One of the leading causes of death for characters who spend Bad Karma is homicide by their former friends.

- **Improved** (+6 CP) raises the bonus to +15 and raises the cap to 10 total Karma.

Leadership (6 CP). You have relatively obedient followers who are willing to follow your orders. By default they're of your general type, but with +3 CP and the Game Master's permission you may command an exotic race, undead, elementals, demons or other outsiders appropriate to your nature, or even (for another +3 CP) animated objects or other constructs.

In any case, you gain followers with a total ECL of (2 x [your level + your Cha Mod]). While none of them can have an ECL greater than (your character level - 3) or less than 1, you may otherwise allocate levels, and describe their personality traits and areas of expertise, as desired. Their equipment is up to the GM, but is usually typical for NPCs. Their levels may be increased, or additional followers may be added, as you go up in level; the Game Master should make adjustments.

While followers are not slavishly loyal unless the character truly deserves such loyalty, they are reliable within reason. Lost followers can be replaced as long as the character is making a reasonable effort to do so and isn't abusing his or her followers; this will usually require 2d6 months.

If you want them, two L0 youths count as 1 level worth of followers, as does a dozen or so small children suitable for employment as pages.

- **Strength in Numbers** (+3 CP) allows you gain numerous servants (don't worry about upkeep) who take care of ordinary, everyday tasks. These servants can be replaced if killed, but the character will not have many willing servants on dangerous voyages or journeys.

- **Horde** (+3 CP) requires Strength in Numbers and adds numerous level 1 warriors as ordinary guards and gofers. Essentially, the character now possesses his or her own guard troop, goon squad, mercenary troop, or any other



source of dependable thugs. These can be replaced if killed, but the character will not have many guards who are willing to go on dangerous voyages or journeys.

- *Beast-lord* (+3 CP) allows a character to take animals or (with GM permission) magical beasts as allies instead of sentient NPC's. Most wilderness types take this when they gain the basic feat. In general, 1 CR equals 1 character level for the purposes of this feat, but GM's may vary this for balance. Any creature with an exotic unlimited-uses-per-day ability should cost +2 levels.

- *Born Leader* (+6 CP) increases the total number of levels of followers available to [3x (your level + Cha Mod)].

- *Emperor's Star* (+6 CP) adds one Positive Level (see page 86) to all your followers. You must describe where, exactly, they gain the CP bonus, and it must be the same for all of them.

Lore (6 CP). A character with Lore gains a broad-based knowledge "skill" at (character level + Intelligence modifier). Classical "Bardic" Lore covers Rumors and Secrets, but fields such as Botany and Zoology, Arts and Entertainment, Outsiders, World Politics, Dungeon Maps and Secrets, and many others are equally appropriate.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, add another kind of Lore.

Luck (6 CP). A lucky character may either "Take 20" in advance, without taking extra time and whether or not this would usually be allowed, or reroll after the primary roll once per day. Most characters also get Bonus Uses.

- *Fortune* (6 CP). If you simply want a character to be generally lucky in life - always finding a parking space just where and when they want one, having the correct change, and otherwise having things go smoothly, buy Fortune. While this makes life easier in many small ways for the character, in mechanical terms the user may shave 20% off of any in-game time requirements.

- Many characters buy Luck "Specialized" *without changing the cost*; this grants one reroll with a certain kind of effect or a situation every time that effect, ability, or situation is used or occurs. This situation must be fairly rare; characters certainly may not reroll failed attack checks or general saves in this manner. For example, a warrior might buy this for Fort saves against instant Death magic, granting a safety margin against evil spellcasters.

Technically this is Specialized Luck with Bonus Uses - but if a particular roll is called for and fails more than five times a day on average it isn't really "fairly rare."

Mana (6 CP). Every level of this ability taken grants an extra 1d6 points of personal Mana, 2d4 generic spell levels, or 3d6 Power. Characters without other psychic abilities do not become vulnerable to psychic attack modes if the game's current rules make psychics more vulnerable to each other. Mana can help with spellcasting, while Power often fuels meditative or martial arts abilities aside from psychic powers.

Unfortunately, while Mana is extremely flexible, it recovers at a mere one point per day, two with rest and meditation. Power and generic spell levels recover each day, as usual.

As a general rule, 1 point of Mana equates to 2 spell levels or 4 Psionic Power - or one charge from a magic item. Mana is commonly used to power exotic abilities. Abilities which would normally be uses-per-day may be designated as using personal Mana instead at 1 use for 2 Mana. If Mana is required as an extra limitation, such powers usually count as Corrupted.

Any character with Mana may select one of the forms of Natural Magic described below at no cost. Adding additional forms costs +6 CP each.

- *Reality Editing*. You may spend Mana to add details to the setting the GM has described. A minor detail consistent with the setting (say, a convenient tapestry or chandelier in the castle hall) costs 1-3 Mana. Notable, but plausible, additions (say a weak





link in the chains or a handy display of weapons on a castle wall) cost 3-5. Major, unlikely, additions (a handy secret passage in your palace, a rescue party showing up two days early) cost 5-10 if the GM opts to allow them at all. Reality editing is always subject to GM approval.

GM's who are quick-thinking and extremely flexible may opt to allow Grandiose additions. Be warned; even at a cost of 9-15 Mana this has the effect of turning over much of the plot and mood of the game to the players.

- **Resilience.** You may spend Mana to counteract or buy off attribute drains or damage at a 1 to 1 ratio, level drains at 2 Mana per level drained, and to resist mind-affecting powers at 2/3/4/6 Mana for effects of levels 0-3/4-6/7-8/9. This is especially popular in Martial Arts based games (see page 80).

- **Spell Enhancement.** You may spend up to three points of personal Mana to enhance a spell. Each point may be used to reduce the effective level of a spell (for casting purposes only) by 1, to add 1 level's worth of known metamagic to it, or to increase the effective Caster Level by +2.

- **Unskilled Magic.** You may simply announce the spell effect you're trying to produce and dump Mana into it.

Whatever-it-is you're trying to do will cost 2 Mana per level of the effect - half of which is wasted and a quarter of which goes into random side effects.

The Casting Level equals the user's level or (Int/3 + the effect level), whichever is less.

The maximum level of effect which can be produced equals the user's base Will save bonus or (Wis/3), whichever is less.

Keeping the side effects down to displays and inconvenient effects (rather than dangerous ones) requires a Cha check at a DC of ([2x the Mana used] + 6). The side effects are always up to the Game Master.

Effects with an extended duration usually require that the caster invest Mana in them; some or all of the Mana used to cast them cannot be recovered while they persist. This does make it easier to cast long-term spells.

Unlike most spellcasting, unskilled magic works better under stress. Characters who are furiously angry, utterly outraged, or otherwise on an emotional peak, gain one free point of Mana, which may be spent in excess of the above limits or be used to reduce the cost. Characters who have just seen their lover or child die, are facing certain death, or who are otherwise in the throes of some great passion, get two. Characters who are dying, or who are willing to die in the casting, get four. Even a relatively unskilled dabbler may be able to manage a decent dying curse.

Mastery (6 CP). Characters with Mastery may "Take 10" under stress for a number of skills equal to 3 x their Intelligence Modifier (minimum 3). Optionally, Mastery may also be applied to Caster Level checks or other d20 checks, although this requires the consent of the Game Master and usually only covers one type of check.

Melding (6 CP). A master of Melding adopts customs and accents instantly. He or she may thus fit into any social, ethnic, or religious group as if he or she had been a member for years, whether this involves an actual disguise or simply not offending the locals and picking up their etiquette. While most casual contact will not reveal the deception, the character also adds his or her Intelligence Modifier to any relevant rolls made to deceive others about the disguise. Melding grants no special language capability.

Mentor (6 CP). You receive special training from some individual or group, whether natural or supernatural. As long as you obey the dictates of your trainer(s) - taking on odd missions for the ancestor spirits who show up to teach you, following the rituals of the sect, or whatever other requirements the Game Master imposes - you gain a 10% bonus on all earned experience.

- **Secret Master** (+6 CP). Your mentor can teach you the secrets of one or more exotic abilities when you're ready to learn them.

- **Prodigy** (+6 CP). You don't need trainers, and so need not listen to their dictates.

This is often taken Specialized, as in "Bonus XP can only be used to create items."

Mindspeech (6 CP). You gain the ability to send and receive thoughts with willing (or at least not unwilling) targets within a 60' radius.

- **Beastspeech** (+6 CP) allows full communication with animals, rather than the simple communication of vague emotions and urges possible with basic Mindspeech. While animals generally aren't very smart, this translates things into rough "speech."

- **Mindlink** (+3 CP) allows you to maintain a contact with a single target no matter how long the range becomes. You may maintain one additional link at a time per +1 CP and may designate specific targets which you can establish a link with at any range per +1 CP each (yes, if they die, you can get in touch with their spirits). Unfortunately, such targets cannot be changed after being selected.

- **Outreach** (+6 CP) allows the user to attempt to set up a Mindlink indirectly using a secondary link to locate the target. Suitable links include being within the domain of a Nature Spirit, having a piece of a deceased individual's body or some other relic of theirs, being at a temple dedicated to a particular god (such calls are normally answered by a minor spirit in the service of the god), or being at an elemental nexus. Unfortunately, this requires at least 1d6 minutes and may require the expenditure of Power or Mana at the option of the Game Master.

- **Sense Sharing** (+3 CP) allows you to see, smell, hear, taste, and feel everything one of your targets does.

- **Spell Transfer** (+6 CP) allows you to give another character you're linked to any beneficial spell effects targeting you.



- *Spell Sharing* (+6 CP) requires Spell Transfer and allows you to share beneficial spell effects targeting you with another character you're currently linked with.
- *Spirit Speech* (+6 CP) allows you to communicate with unlinked creatures on coexistent planes. For an additional +6 CP the user may attempt to communicate with individuals on other planes in general.
- *Skill Sharing* (+6 CP) allows you to share up to 2 CP worth of your skills and/or knowledge-based abilities with anyone you're currently maintaining a Mindlink with.



So where's the trigger on this thing?

Mystic Artist (6 CP). Mystic Artists inspire and manipulate others through art. While music, dance, and oratory are the most common forms, storytelling, painting, or architecture also work. See page 84.

Mystic Link (3 CP). A character with Mystic Link has an occult bond with someone or something. He or she may sense the target or the direction it lies in.

- *Communications* (+3 CP) allows the user to communicate with the target. This normally only works with living targets, although computers and sentient magic items are eligible.
- *Power Link* (+3 CP) allows user to use spells or other powers on the target, or have the target use spells or other powers on him or her regardless of range.

Inanimate power sources can simply be tapped as if they were in hand.

- *Summons Link* (+3 CP) grants the power for the character to teleport the target to his or her location. This costs extra (+3 CP) if the target is animate and only works on things the user could pick up normally.
- *Travel Link* (+6 CP) requires Summons Link and enables the character to teleport to the target.
- *Identity Link* (+3 CP) mystically bonds the character and target. Any spell effects which affects one also affects the other.
- *Transferable* (+6 CP) allows the character to switch which person or object he or she has a link with.
- *Runebinding* (+6 CP) grants the character the ability to enchant a specific (non-transferable) inanimate target. The character requires no other feats to do so, but all enchantments are subject to the approval of the GM.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, you create a separate mystic link. Upgrades apply to all your Mystic Link powers.

Occult Sense (6 CP). Occult Sense grants the character a new sense, such as lowlight vision, deathsense (allowing you to sense when someone is near death), the ability to accurately date objects by touch, the ability to sense radiation or magnetic fields, the ability to see ethereal spirits, automatically sensing the current astrological modifiers (if such things are used), and so on. Occult Sense generally counteracts minor penalties or allows minor added abilities.

- More powerful senses, such as Darkvision (where the character sees even in total darkness) cost the same, but come with limitations. This usually amounts to either being usable 3/day with a duration in rounds equal to the character's level or greatly limited range, usually 60'. Extremely powerful senses are usually only usable in special circumstances.
- *Improved* (+6 CP) allows the character to use a powerful sense at will instead of 3 times per day or extends the range to be like normal sight.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, you gain another sense.

Occult Skill (3 CP). Purchasing Occult Skill grants a character access to any skill designated as "Restricted" by the Game Master, usually because it requires secret knowledge or special powers to learn in the campaign setting. The skill becomes an "irrelevant" skill for the character's class. This requires GM permission.

- You may take this ability multiple times.
- As usual, if you spend 6 CP buying levels in an irrelevant skill, it becomes relevant from that point forward.

Sample Restricted Skills

Shadow Walk (Wis, Trained Only)

Use this skill to navigate or adjust to areas of warped reality - dimensional fringes, dream realms, and the quasi-illusory legend realms shaped by popular tales and myths. Note that navigating a dreamscape or legend realm generally involves “maneuvering” through roles and sequences of events as well as mere physical movement.

Check: Shadow Walk is primarily an intuitive, rather than a rational, skill; the DC is subject to unpredictable changes.

<u>Legendary Realm</u>	DC	<u>Dream Realm</u>	DC
Follow Plotline	10	Alter Scene	10
Locate Sidequest	15	Shift Scene	15
Locate Exit	25	Find Secret	20
Derail Plotline	30	Shift Dreamers	25

<u>Dimensional Fringe</u>	DC
Follow marked path / tail someone	15
Locate stable path / memorize route	20
Locate loosely-defined dimension/realm	25
Locate specific hidden realm	35
Locate realm of heart's desire	45

Special: Characters with a Knowledge skill appropriate to the dimensional region they're operating in at rank 5+ gain a +2 synergy bonus on Shadow Walk.

Of course, unless you live in an unstable dimension or on the fringes of a dimensional crossroads realm, you're unlikely to even know of the existence of such a skill.

Some other restricted skills might include *Glowstone Alchemy* (requires the use of glowstone - which is only found in a few realms), *Kel Vordant* (a long lost tongue of the high gods, a language of true names and the direct command of reality), and *Subsumption* (a ritualistic way to gain magical powers by eating people and creatures who possessed them; this drives you more than a bit mad and is only common among the Yer Cannibals).

Occult Talent (6 CP). Occult Talent covers a variety of minor magical abilities. These require no components but never rise above 1st level spells. The basic effect allows a character four level 0 spells and one level 1 spell, which he or she may use 1/day each. This does not allow the character to use items which normally require spellcasting abilities.

- **Improved** (+6 CP) allows the character to expand his or her repertoire considerably. He or she now has a selection of five level 0 spells and three level 1 spells. He or she gains 5 level 0 slots and three level 1 slots to cast them with as a Sorcerer or Psion would.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Upgrades do not carry over from one instance to the next.

Opportunist (6 CP). A character with Opportunist selects a particular type of action (most often a single attack) and particular situation when you normally could not take that action. You may use your action under that specific circumstance from now on. For example, the basic Rogue can attack opponents who were just injured by another character.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time it applies to a new action and/or situation.

Poison Use (6 CP). Characters with Poison Use no longer risk self-poisoning when using poison and may make various toxins using Alchemy, assuming that is not considered a normal part of the skill.

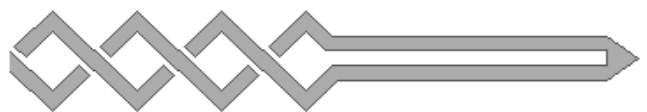
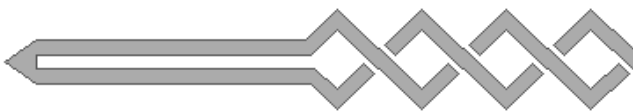
Power Words (6 CP). Power Words enable the character to store up to (Con score/3) total spell levels and release them as Move-Equivalent Actions. A character may release one spell per round in this fashion.

- **Improved** (+6 CP) increases the total spell levels which can be stored to (Con score/2).
- **Superior** (+3 CP) requires Improved and increases the total spell levels which can be stored to (2*Con score/3).
- **Harbingers** (+6 CP) allows a character to release up to two Power Words per round.
- **Spellform** (+6 CP) allows a character to invest 2 HP per spell level to make a Power Word quasi-sentient. It activates as desired without taking part of the character's action. Most are purely mental constructs, but some spellforms have material bodies and can fly about near their owner. Unfortunately, “killing” them does nothing aside from dissipating them for 1d4 minutes.
- **Sendings** (+6 CP) allows the character to send their Spellforms on errands. While not very bright, they're capable of locating a place or person nearby (and going off there) if given good directions or if the user is familiar with the area.

If a character creates Spellforms, but doesn't use them within a few weeks, they tend to become more alive. More than one magician has discovered to his or her shock that he or she now really does have an angel over one shoulder and a devil on the other. While never hostile to the character, such Spellforms might well qualify as living beings, albeit immature and with one-track minds stemming from the single spell they have. These living Spellforms permanently take up spell levels from the character's available Power Word pool, but can use their powers twice per day without additional cost or chance of spell failure.

Presence (6 CP). With Presence, your character influences those around you. The base level extends to a 10-foot radius and can induce simple effects such as courage (immunity to fear), a -2 morale penalty, or some other specific effect similar to a L1 spell.

- **Improved** (+6 CP) adds +4 to any social skill roll made with the backing of Presence. This means that characters with auras of holiness or purity gain the bonus when



dealing with decent folk, while characters with auras of evil and corruption gain the bonus when bribing or intimidating others. Unlike the basic effect, such modifiers can affect anyone and everyone you interact with. Of course, this also marks you, and will doubtless draw a good deal of attention.

- *Superior* (+6 CP) requires *Improved* and forces all would-be attackers to make Will saves (DC 13 + character's Cha Mod) or be unable to attack, either out of fear, awe, loathing, love, insanity, or because they're rolling on the ground laughing. The save must be repeated each round, although victims get a +5 bonus if the user is currently attacking them.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Upgrades do not carry over from one instance to the next and no more than one roll is ever required to attack you.



Do I need Presence to look evil, or is that free?

Privilege (3 CP). Privilege grants the character special legal and social advantages. The character must define exactly what the privilege is (and preferably how he or she obtained it). The ability to sell restricted goods legally, carry weapons openly about a city, or come and go from the palace make good minor privileges. Characters may also simply come from wealthy families, in which case they're entitled to a few servants and some extra starting cash at lower levels.

- *Major* (+3 CP) increases the entitlement to a higher level. Being a guildmaster, high-ranking officer in the army, or powerful bureaucrat are all good examples.

- Privileges vary considerably from place to place within a campaign world. Since they're almost always tied to specific locations, organizations, or governments,

they are fairly cheap. Good examples of privileges include Civil Authority, Minor Income (enough to support a family on), Legal Immunities, or Guild Membership.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Upgrades do not carry over from one instance to the next.

Players often ask why they need to spend CP on things they acquire through cleverness, roleplaying, or grants from NPCs. It's simply because all of those things require time and effort from the character - whether coming up with and implementing the ideas, spending time with the NPC's, or dealing with whatever complications come with the grant. The character won't have as much time to develop other abilities. Of course, if the GM really wants to hand out freebies, so be it.

Professional (6 CP). Professional grants a +(level/2) (rounded down, +10 Max) bonus on a particular skill. Only levels gained after taking this ability count.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time it applies to a new skill.

Reflex Training (6 CP). With Reflex Training, a character gains a free, immediate, Standard Action under some particular circumstance. You cannot string together more reflexive actions than your relevant attribute bonus (usually Str Mod or Dex Mod). Alternatively, the character may instead simply take an extra Standard Action at any time 3 times per day. You may not use this version more than once per round.

- *Improved* (+6 CP) allows you to take as many actions as you can trigger. The circumstances must be extremely narrow. Extra Standard Actions require Bonus Uses.

- You may take this ability multiple times to gain actions under multiple circumstances. Upgrades do not carry over.

Reputation (6 CP). Reputation means the character is widely known, at least in certain circles, for his or her skills, talents, or deeds. Describe what he or she is known for - and to which groups.

- The Game Master may simply note the reputation and apply it when appropriate. If a mechanic is desired, NPC's in the affected group make an (Int + Rep Score) check at DC 20 to have heard of the character. A character's base score is equal to his or her (level/3)

- If an NPC is aware of a character's reputation, the character may gain - or suffer - a modifier of up to + or -5 on relevant social skill checks. A reputation as a criminal mastermind rarely helps with city guards, but is often useful on the street.

- *Improved* (+3 CP) increases the character's reputation score to Level/2.

- *Superior* (+3 CP) increases the character's reputation score to (2xLevel)/3.

Characters who want to attract followers should simply buy Leadership and describe it as an effect of their reputations.

Researcher (6 CP). Characters with Researcher may invent new spells, arts, and items within a chosen specialty in half the usual time and at half the usual cost. Sorcerers and other intuitive spellcasters may simply take original spells in their new spell allotment.

- **Invention** (+6 CP) allows the user to spend CP to create new technologies or fields, rather than merely new applications of existing techniques. The cost and actual availability of technologies depend largely on the GM's willingness to vet or create new material.
- **Analyst** (+6 CP) allows a character to discover the mechanisms or principles behind any item or observed effect related to his or her research specialty given a few weeks to study it.

Resist (3 CP). This is the basic improved-saving-throw effect. Each level of Resist grants a +1 bonus in a saving throw category OR a +2 bonus on all saving throws against some specialized group of effects (poison, energy and ability drain, charm and mind control, etc.).

- You may take this ability multiple times, although the Game Master should question huge specialized bonuses.

Returning (6 CP). A powerful but expensive technique favored by villains, Returning allows a character to return from death. The basic form requires that enemies take special precautions, such as burning or shredding the character's body or sprinkling his or her grave with Holy Water, to prevent the return. Usually, the character will return as an outsider, elemental, golem (albeit sentient), or undead.

- **Extraordinary** (+6 CP) makes it even harder to keep the user from coming back. For example, the user's tomb must be totally destroyed to keep him or her from coming back.
- **Unique** (+6 CP) requires Extraordinary and allows the character to return except for one particular method, which alone may destroy him or her. Examples might include a character who can only be killed by stealing his or her signet ring and throwing it into the volcano in which it was forged.
- **Rewrite** entitles a character to a minor (1/4 of CP), major (1/2 CP), or total (all CP) rewrite of his or her abilities at a cost of +6, +12, or +18 CP, respectively. The character does not need to have Returning among the new character abilities. Of course, this only activates when the character revives.
- The GM normally gets to decide what type of being the new character will be. For 6 CP, the character may designate a type, such as undead or good outsider. For 12 CP, he or she may designate a specific form (such as lich or archon), although his or her personal abilities may still vary considerably from the norm for that creature.
- Returning never changes a character's alignment. The character might change personality, but that's a decision for the player. The GM is encouraged to enforce certain limits; a character given to gross selfishness or acts of wanton cruelty is unlikely to return in the form of a holy

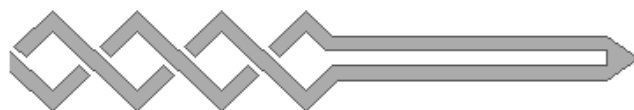
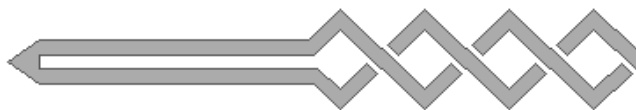
champion of light without a *very* good explanation, regardless of what the player wrote on the character sheet.



Yes, you did chop all my limbs off. But I've got Returning.

Rider (6 CP). With Rider, characters can aid their mounts in battle. This initially allows them to use a Ride roll in place of his or her mount's AC to negate a hit on the mount once per round. A Rider is not limited to any specific creature or type of creature.

- **Vehicle** (+6 CP) allows these bonuses to apply to a vehicle type instead of any creature. At the GM's option, this may make a specific vehicle at least partially sentient and give it basic mental ability scores. This further applies to all future feats taken from this list. Vehicles normally use a "Pilot" check instead of Ride, but the skills are identical save for the name.
- **Might** (+6 CP) adds the Faithful Steed template to a creature. See page 167 for the template.
- **Psychic Bond** (+6 CP) creates a subtle psychic bond between rider and mount. This grants a +5 bonus to Ride and allows the character to communicate with his or her mount mentally. For an additional +6 CP the character may call his or her mount and have it simply show up, regardless of how impractical this is.
- **Sensory Link** (+3 CP) requires Psychic Bond and allows a character to share senses with his or her Mount.
- **Sharing** (+3 CP) allows a character to share the effects a beneficial spell targeting him or her with the mount.



- *Ward* (+6 CP) requires Sharing and allows any of the riders personal magical, psionic, or ability-based defenses to apply to the mount as well, at least as far as the GM will put up with it.
- *Spirited* (+3 CP) adds +10' or +10% (whichever is better) to one of the Mount's movement modes. This can be taken repeatedly, but can't more than double a mode.
- *Stable Seat* (+3 CP) cuts the penalties for using ranged weapons or other powers while mounted in half.
- *Improved Stable Seating* (+6 CP) eliminates all penalties for using ranged weapons or other powers while mounted.
- *Battle Dance* (+3 CP) allows a character to add his or her (Wis Mod) to the Mount's AC.
- *Overbear* (+3 CP) allows the mount to use the equivalent of a Trip attack without incurring an Attack of Opportunity by ramming into people. The mount receives a free attack if this succeeds.

Rite of Chi (6 CP). Given a few minutes of rest, one with the knowledge of Chi may regain 4d6 power, 2d6 spell levels (the user allocates where these go), or 1d6 Mana once per day. Characters may use this more often, but incur a cumulative -1 negative level each time (these go away in 24 hours). Characters with Bonus Uses do not suffer this as long as their Bonus Uses hold out.

Sanctum (6 CP). A character with Sanctum may establish a personal place of power (such as a building, grove, or dungeon) and gain +24 CP while inside it. The character must define what bonuses he or she gains when the sanctum is defined. These only apply in the Sanctum (no, you can't count that as Specialized).

- *Occult Wards* (+3 CP) keep people from entering. The player may designate the exact form (traps, force barriers, secret doors, or simply steering people away are common choices). The CR for any part of the ward is equal to half the character's level.
- *Guardians* (+6 CP) protect the Sanctum from intruders. The player may set the form (undead, outsiders, and golems are common choices). The CR for any creature is equal to half the character's level.
- *Spirit-tie* (+3 CP) summons the character back to the Sanctum after dying, where he or she can hopefully be revived (or he or she has a pre-existing resurrection method). This prevents the character from moving on to the afterlife unless he or she wishes it.
- *Variable* (+3 CP) allows the character to change his or her Sanctum abilities whenever he or she gains a level. Many characters experiment with feats or magic, buying them first in a Sanctum and then permanently.

Schooling (+3 CP) Schooling allows characters to use a variant class description for buying abilities without penalty. For point-based characters this also bypasses retraining time for changing classes.

- *Additional Favored Class* (+3 CP) allows characters in games with more restrictive class systems to select an

additional favored class.

- *Additional Favored Classes* (+6 CP) allows a character to select three classes as additional favored classes.
- *All Classes Favored* (+9 CP) allows a character to use all classes or builds as favored classes.

Self-Development (6 CP). This feat increases a character's attribute by +1 for a specific purpose, such as Strength for to-hit bonuses or Dex for AC calculation.

- This ability helps low attributes more than high ones. Attributes with a base score of 3-6 or 7-9 go up by +3 or +2, respectively, instead of by +1.
- *Improved* (+6 CP) improves the attribute permanently for all purposes, instead of only for a specific purpose.
- You may take this ability multiple times to boost your attribute(s) to any desired level.

Shadowmaster (6 CP). Shadowmaster boosts the "reality" of shadow magic (this primarily affects a small number of Illusion spells) by 5% per spellcaster level, to a maximum of +50% over the spell base or 100% in total, whichever comes first.

- *Upgrade* (+6 CP) increases the maximum bonus to +75%. The maximum possible total remains at 100%.

Shapeshift (6 CP) You may take Small or Medium animal forms once per day per 3 character levels as a Standard Action. You may not take a form with more hit dice than you possess. All equipment you carry melds with your new form and is unusable. The new form lasts until you decide to change back. As a side effect, shapeshifters can revert to normal form when polymorphed.



*Is it cannibalism if I wasn't
human when I ate him?*

ECLIPSE: THE CODEX PERSONA



Shapeshift Type Extensions

- **Beasts** (+3 CP) allows the user to take on Magical Beast forms. This is commonly Corrupted to a specific form or small group of forms, but this is not required.
- **Dire** (+3 CP) allows Dire animals.
- **Dragon** (+6 CP) allows the user to take on Dragon forms. The user is still restricted by size and hit dice.
- **Elemental** (+3 CP) allows Elemental forms as well as animal ones. Characters who can take on elemental forms may revert from petrification. For +3 CP the user may take on all elemental creature forms.
- **Ooze** (+6 CP) allows Ooze transformations as well as animal ones.
- **Plant** (+3 CP) allows Plant forms as well as animal ones.
- **Shape of Death** (+6 CP) allows the user to take on corporeal undead forms. The ability to take incorporeal forms costs another +6 CP.
- **Verminform** (+3 CP) allows the user to take on Vermin forms. For a further +6 CP, the user may take on the Swarm type.
- **Enchanted** (+6 CP per form type) allows the user to use a form's extraordinary and supernatural abilities, but not its spell-like or spellcasting abilities. This only costs 3 CP for Elemental and Vermin forms.

Shapeshifting does not extend to Aberrations, Constructs, or Outer-planar creatures unless the user is already one of those types, in which case it extends to that type only.

Shapeshift Size Modifications

- **Growth*** (+3 CP) allows Large or Huge forms. For +6 CP this can be extended to Gargantuan forms, for another +12 to Colossal forms, and for a further +24 to Mountainous. See page 62.
- **Shrinking*** (+3 CP) allows Tiny or Diminutive forms. For +6 CP this may be extended to Fine and for another +12 CP this may be extended to microscale forms (page 62).

Size changes may be pro-rated according to the user's normal size. For example, a creature which is already Huge only needs +3 CP to reach Colossal, but must pay +3 CP to reach Medium-sized.

Shapeshift Internal Modifications

- **Attribute Modifiers** (+6 CP) allows the user to take on the physical attribute modifiers of a form, instead of simply taking its average physical attributes.
- **Attribute Shift** (+6 CP) allows the character to move around up to 6 points of physical attributes when he or she shapechanges.
- **Hybrid** (+6 CP) allows a shapeshifter to make a partial change, mixing animal characteristics with their natural form. In general, this means that they can continue to use weapons, items, and sometimes armor, while in "animal" form but must spend another +6 CP to be able to speak clearly.

- **Spirit of the Wild** (+12 CP) allows the user to take on a particular extraordinary or supernatural ability from among those he or she could access via shapeshifting for an hour without actually changing form. For example, the user could take on a Cheetah's extraordinary speed.
- **Variants** (+3 CP), a catch-all category, allows the shape-shifter to make alterations in his or her forms. He or she may assume any variation available to any normal member of any species he or she can become. This is equivalent to a continuous *Alter Self* effect.
- **Wild Essence** (+12 CP) lets you use a shift to take on a type from among those you can normally attain without changing physically. For example you could change your type from Humanoid to Plant to gain temporary immunity to poisons. Each use of Wild Essence lasts for one hour.

Shapeshift Inherent Constructs

- **Creatures of Blood** (+6 CP) allows shape-shifters to create constructs from their own blood. These function exactly like whatever creature the shape-shifter mimics in creating it, which must be one he or she can turn into. The shape-shifter must sacrifice a number of hit points equal to the creature's normal maximum to create one. These creatures cannot use supernatural or spell-like abilities. They last for 1 hour per level. For +6 CP this can be extended to one day per level.
- **Magic of Blood** (+6 CP) requires Creatures of Blood and allows the creation of creatures which can use supernatural or spell-like abilities.

Shapeshift Magical Modifications

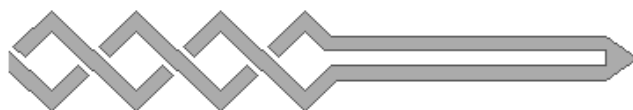
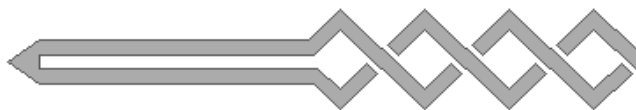
- **Exemption** (+3 CP) allows the character to leave out selected items while shapeshifting. Items which would fit the new form will remain in place.
- **Inanimate** (+12 CP) allows the character to shapeshift his or her equipment to fit his or her new form. This may be Specialized if magical, psionic, or high-tech gear does not function while shapeshifted.
- **Natural Magic** (+6 CP) allows a character in animal or plant form to cast spells even without hands or the ability to speak. He or she may use components if he or she had them before transforming.
- **Sharing** (+6 CP) allows the character to transform a willing subject other than herself. This lasts until the creature decides to return to its normal form.

While there are hordes of other abilities which can be described as "shapeshifting," that's only a special effect: buy them directly and describe them as you like.

Shaping (6 CP). Shaping allows you to channel ambient magical energy into *Prestidigitation* at will. This is the first step along the Path of the Dragon, as presented on page 92, and is explained further there.

Shaping, and its higher-order variants, can also be used to build characters with weak, but unlimited-use, abilities, such as many minor "superheroes."





Siddhis yoga (6 CP) You may sacrifice treasure to give yourself innate mystical abilities (equivalent to magic items) with a total price equal to one-half the value of the sacrificed treasure. You may spend this on any desired enchantment without regard for item slots. Some effects, such as *True Strike* and *Cure Light Wounds* may not be taken as unlimited-use (such effects are normally limited to a maximum of three uses per day). The powers purchased must be approved by the Game Master.

- **Fey** (+6 CP). You may double the power gained from your sacrifices by spending 1 XP per 20 GP worth of treasure sacrificed. Thus gaining an innate enchantment worth 1000 GP would cost 2000 GP or 1000 GP and 50 XP.

- **Efficient** (+6 CP). You gain abilities with a total price equal to 2/3rds the value of the sacrificed treasure.

- **Inner Whispers** (+6 CP). You may “buy” charged items and recharge them by expending twice the amount of XP it would take to make them normally.

If you want the power in your character, rather than in a pile of items, this is the ability for you.

Skill Emphasis (3 CP) This grants a +2 bonus on any single skill.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Skill Emphasis may only be taken once on any single skill, though you may still purchase it for other skills.

Skill Focus (2/4/6 CP). This grants a +1/2/3 bonus to any single skill. Skill Focus stacks with Skill Emphasis.

- **Mastery** (+3 CP) grants an additional +1 bonus to any single skill. It may be taken twice, for a maximum bonus of +7 when combined with Skill Emphasis.

- **Speed** (+6 CP) reduces the required time to use the skill by half. Skill-based actions which normally require one round become Move-Equivalent Actions.

- **Stunt** (+6 CP) permits supernatural stunts with the skill at the cost of 2 temporary attribute points or 2 Mana. This covers things like using *Escape Artist* to escape a *Sphere of Force*, stitching together a flesh golem with *Heal*, or talking a berserk rampaging monster out of eating the party with *Diplomacy*. Note that this doesn't decrease the (likely high) difficulty of such actions; it simply makes them possible.

- **Epic Stunts** (+6 CP) requires *Stunt* and a minimum skill rank of 24. It allows you to perform astounding feats using the selected skill up to (Skill Level/10) times

daily. Sadly, each such stunt must be researched as if it was a high-level spell and will require a successful skill check to use.

Yes, if you apply this to Spellcraft this is the Point-Buy gateway to using the existing SRD epic spell system. Personally, we recommend using Invocation (page 35) and the high-level spell list (page 122) instead.

- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time it applies to a different skill. Enhancements do not carry over.

Snatch (3 CP). A character with Snatch may make a Reflex check (DC 15) to grab any available or unattended item, including the weapons of disarmed opponents, in a free hand as a Free Action.

- **Upgraded** (+3 CP) reduces the DC to 10.

This variant on Reflex Training warranted an independent listing.

Specialist (3 CP). With Specialist, a character selects one magical specialty, usually an arcane school or a pair of divine domains. The character gains an extra spell slot of each spell level he or she can use of up to level 3. He or she may only memorize or cast spells using these slots with the chosen speciality. Characters may take this without selecting a magical specialty and put any spell in it, but this doubles the base cost as well as the cost of any improvements. Characters using Divine Magic need pay only half price for Specialist.

- **Improved** (+3 CP) extends the spell slots up to level 6.

- **Superior** (+6 CP) requires Improved and extends the spell slots up to level 9.

Spell Conversion (6 CP). A character with Spell Conversion selects a limited number of spells according to his or her class theme, usually nine (one for each spell level). The user may convert a prepared spell of equal or higher level into one of them spontaneously. The user must already have access to the spells he or she selects for Spell Conversion.

Clerics use this the most, but anyone may have it.

Spell Flow (6 CP). A spontaneous caster with Spell Flow adds up all the levels of spells he or she learns from then on. Level 0 spells count as 1/2 spell level. The caster may expend these as desired to learn any level of spell he or she can cast.



Equipment? Bah! Equipment is a crutch for the weak and untrained!

Spell Mastery (6 CP). Characters with Spell Mastery no longer require source material (*i.e.*, a spellbook) to prepare a number of selected spells equal to their Intelligence Modifier.

- **Efficient** (+6 CP) allows the user to double his or her effective Int modifier as far as Spell Mastery goes.
- **Rapid** (+3 CP) allows such spells to be prepared in a mere 1d6 rounds. Spontaneous (+3 additional CP) allows the use of such spells as if the caster were a spontaneous caster.
- **Signature** (+6 CP) allows the character to transform other prepared spells of equal or greater level into one of the mastered spells.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it affects different spells. Any improvements other than Efficient must be purchased for each set of spells.

Spell Pool (6 CP). A character with Spell Pool adds up all available spell levels (level 0 spells count as 1/2 spell level) from a single chosen progression and uses them as “spell points.” Each spell uses a number of points equal to its level. This does not bypass the limitations of the level of spells which may be cast.

The maximum number of spells of any one level which can be cast or memorized equals ([spellcasting attribute/2] - Spell Level). For example, a Wizard with 16 Intelligence could cast a maximum of seven 1st level spells, six second level spells, five 3rd level spells, four 4th level spells, and so on.

Spell/Power Resistance (6 CP). Once purchased, the character gains Spell or Power Resistance which rises with his or her level, rated at (5 + character level).

- **Improved** (+6 CP) increases the resistance by +5. This may be bought twice.

Spell Shorthand (6 CP). You may record your spells in half the usual space, at half the usual expense, and in half the usual time.

- **Cryptoglyphics** (+3 CP). You can read dangerous magical inscriptions, including Glyphs, Symbols, and enchanted Tomes without triggering the magic they contain.

OK, this is simply a minor Immunity, but it's popular with the more studious mages.

- **Encryption** (+3 CP). You may convert a spell formula of any level into a one-page mystical diagram. Sadly, no one without this ability can understand them at all.
- **Formal Notation** (+3 CP). Other spellcasters can prepare spells from your books without a Spellcraft check or having to already have the spell recorded in their own books. Perhaps fortunately, thanks to the special inks and procedures required, spellbooks still can't be printed *en mass*.
- **Runemaster** (+3 CP). You may mystically inscribe spells on bizarre mediums. For example, you may embed them in pearls, paint them on shields, or tattoo them as strange glyphs on the skin.

- **Hieratics** (+3 CP). You have an inherent ability to *Read Magic* and can prepare spells from other character's spell books without a Spellcraft check

Preparing a spell from another character's books usually requires a Spellcraft check. Mastering a spell book allows you to use the book as if you had written it. This requires two weeks and a successful Spellcraft check at a DC of (26 + The highest level of spell in the book).

Spell Storing (6 CP). Spell Storing is sufficiently complex to warrant it's own section in Chapter Three (see page 98).

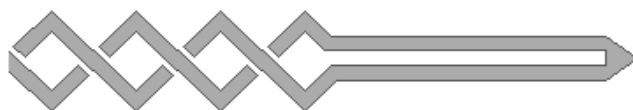
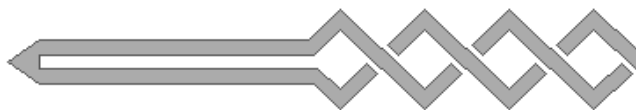
Spell Turning (6 CP). With Spell Turning, a successful counterspell enables the caster to redirect it back at the caster or the caster's location. If neither of these is a valid target, the spell fails.

Stoic (6 CP). Characters with Stoic are not subject to death by massive damage and may make a Fortitude save (DC 15) each round to self-stabilize if below 0 HP.

- **Improved** (+6 CP) allows a character to survive until he or she reaches -30 hit points, although he or she still loses consciousness at 0 hit points.
- **Ferocity** (+3 CP) allows characters to act normally while at negative HP (but not while dead) until after the battle.
- **Juggernaut** (+6 CP) requires Ferocity and allows characters to remain active for three rounds after dying. Although no amount of healing can help them, only resurrection magic, characters with this feat who die may remain active and continue to fight, cast spells, or take any normal action. The GM may or may not allow characters disintegrated or otherwise destroyed to remain active – this depends on the world and whether or not the thought amuses him or her.



Party! Party! Party! Wooh!



Superstition (6 CP) This interesting talent allows Divine spellcasting without a supernatural patron or quasi-sentient source of power. Characters may cast up to level 2 spells with nothing more than their will to back them. Level 3 spells require at least some sort of personal belief or code of conduct (yes, you can decide that you're a god and invoke yourself), and characters who subscribe to a popular code, belief, or superstition can cast spells of up to level 4 regardless of its validity.

Test of Wills (3 CP). Test of Wills enables a character to use one action making an opposed Will save against a nearby (60' or so) enemy. The loser becomes *Shaken*. Creatures immune to fear take no penalties from this ability, though if they win the opponent does receive the penalty (unless the opponent is also immune to fear). The effect usually lasts for 1 round per level of the initiator. This does not work when you're actually in battle, but does work at any time before combat actually begins, even if both sides desire a fight.

- **Checked** (+3 CP) upgrades the result so that the loser becomes *Checked*.

- **Subordinated** (+3 CP) requires Checked and makes the loser becomes *Subordinated*. (The winner gets a +2 on attack rolls and the save DC's of any powers used against the loser).

- **Frightened** (+3 CP) requires Subordinated and makes the loser become *Frightened*.

- **Extended** (+6 CP) makes the effect last 1 minute per level of the initiator.

- **Binding** (+9 CP) requires Frightened and allows the user, if victorious, to issue a command to the loser. These commands must be short, simple orders. While the target must follow them for the duration of the effect it will not normally attack its allies or commit suicide unless it has severe loyalty issues or just plain lacks sanity. Some effects, like commanding a fiend to return to its native plane, can effectively take a creature out without resistance or further complications.

- **Mob** (+6 CP) allows the initiator to stare down a mob of low level people (half the initiator's level or less). Make the roll only for the enemy with the highest Will.

Thaumaturgy (6 CP). Thaumaturgy allows the control of primal forces and powers. Often possessed by Shamans and barbarian cultures, these allow for powerful effects bounded not by mathematical law or

divine providence, but the limits of the user's own will. See *Thaumaturgy and Dweomer*, page 100.

Theurgy (6 CP). You've found a way to link divine and arcane magic. In general, converting between the druid, bard, and wizard/sorcerer lists adds one level, as does converting between the druid, ranger, paladin, and cleric lists. Any other conversions, such as between cleric and wizard, add +2 levels unless the Game Master rules otherwise. The user must either have access to the spell to be converted (whether personally or from a friend, scroll, or deity) or must research it normally.

Thus a cleric who wants to learn *Fireball* can either learn it from a wizard or research it, but it becomes fifth level as a clerical spell in any case. The level adjustment applies even if the spell is present, and of lower level, on the list in question anyway. Converting the arcane version of *Bull's Strength* to a clerical spell results in an inefficient fourth level spell.

A distinct and unrelated set of skills called Theurgy appears in Chapter 3. Sorry, but we ran out of names.



You kids today! When I started fighting Evil all we had to work with was...

Timeless Body (3 CP). You no longer age, do not suffer aging penalties (although benefits still accrue), and will not die naturally until reaching your maximum racial lifespan. Cosmetic aging may or may not continue at the option of the user. Most characters simply look the same for the rest of their lives, but sages and ancient kung-fu masters are notorious for looking fantastically aged. Timeless Body is free in games based around hacking monsters to bits each week with little-to-no downtime.

- **Transcendence** (+6 CP, minimum level 10) transforms a character into some sort of magical being, without altering his or her basic form or abilities. Native Outsiders are the most common, but Plant creatures or other strange variants are possible. This generally includes DR 10/Magic, a change in type, and possibly some minor abilities that come with the template.

- **Rejuvenation** (+6 CP) negates any age-based attribute penalties the character may have suffered previously.

- **Age Shifting** (+3 CP, requires Rejuvenation) lets you assume any desired physical age, including the age-based physical attribute modifiers.

Characters who want to extend their natural lifespans should purchase Immunity/Aging.



Tireless (6 CP) removes cumulative penalties for lengthy efforts. The character never becomes exhausted from normal physical efforts.

This is another Specialized Immunity, but was used so often that it merited its own listing.

Toughness (2 CP). With Toughness, you gain +1 HP per 2 CP invested. You gain no bonus or penalty for a high or low Con modifier from these.

Toughness is included for 3.0 back-compatibility only. Characters who seriously want more HP should buy larger Hit Dice, increase their Constitution scores, or buy special bonuses.

Traceless (6 CP). Traceless characters leave no discernable traces of a particular type of activity. The user must choose a specific form. Common forms include:

- *Travel* means the character leaves no traces when moving about. The character leaves no footprints, disturbs no leaves, and breaks no twigs.
- *Magic* means the character leaves no aura behind and his or her magic does not leave a discernable trace. It does not help with enemies using direct divination or assessing his or her aura in person.
- *Genetic* means the character leaves no personal biological evidence, such as fingerprints or usable DNA.

- More exotic forms include *Murder* (the victim remains dead, but there is no discernable cause of death and no blood or other traces), *Computer Hacking*, *Surgery*, and many more. This may be taken multiple times, each time applying to another activity.

Track (3 CP). Characters with this feat select Urban, Wilderness, or Dimensional tracking. Tracking requires a Survival (for wilderness) or Gather Information (for urban) check every mile to follow the target. This is DC 15 for favorable conditions, DC 20 for unfavorable ones. Size bonuses on Hide checks apply, and unfavorable lighting may inflict penalties. Dimensional tracking relies on Spellcraft and can trace *Gates* or teleportation and dimensional travel.

- *Identification* (+3 CP) allows the character to make a relevant knowledge check to determine the species (and any other tracking-related information, such as a limp and its size) of creature he or she is tracking.
- *Deduction* (+3 CP) requires Identification and allows the character to discover absurdly accurate information (see below) with a successful (DC 35) tracking check.
- *Style* (+6 CP) grants another method of tracking. A tracker might purchase Style: Scent, for example, and trace the enemy by smell. Another character might purchase Magical Traces, and could attempt to track by observing residual spell energies. Either way, this





counters -10 points' worth of penalties on the DC for the tracking check. It grants no inherent ability to use the selected sense, only the ability to track with it.

- You may purchase this ability multiple times. Upgrades carry over.

"There were two of them – both using their left hands and both master swordsmen. They fought several hours ago. They battled up here on the rocks, then moved down there. Wait! One of them switched hands. They dueled around the tree. Now the other one switched hands. The winner disarmed the loser here, and then knocked him out. It must have taken several minutes for him to come round again, then he ran off that way."

Travel (3 CP). Travel grants the ability to move unhindered by a particular type of natural terrain, such as forest, mountain, tundra, or even asteroid field. It reduces travel time by 25% in that terrain for the character, but does not add to melee-scale movement.

- **Add Terrain** (+6 CP) adds one terrain type to the terrains a character's Travel abilities function in. You may add as many different terrains as you desire.

- **Mount** (+3 CP) makes the Travel ability affect your horse, other riding animal, or vehicle as well.

- **Group** (+6 CP) makes the Travel ability affect your whole party (up to [Charisma] characters). With Mount, it affects the entire party and their mounts or vehicles.

- **Fast** (+6 CP) increases the character's travel time reduction to 50%.

- **Swift** (+6 CP) requires Fast and increases the character's travel time reduction to 75%. Zoom.

- **Trailblazing** (+6 CP) allows the character to avoid random encounters. With a successful Survival (DC at GMO, usually 15-25 depending on the monster), the character may avoid a random encounter or allow his or her allies to prepare for the fight. He or she may even set snares, ambushes, and traps, time and skill permitting.

- **Improved Trailblazing** (+6 CP) entitles a character to a 3-round warning that he or she is entering a dangerous area even on a failed Trailblazing check.

Triggering (6 CP). Triggering enables a character to release a spell or power from his or her personal reserves or from a type of item without expending a use of the power. The user must specify a specific type of ability or item (wands, staves, a specific spell-like ability or prepared spell, etc.) when this ability is taken.

- This requires an attribute check (usually Int or Cha for Arcane casters, Wis for Divine casters, or the relevant attribute for a Psychic) with a DC of 11/13/15/17/21 for level 0/1/2/3/4 effects. Failure means the character does expend a use of the ability in question.

Turn Resistance (2 CP). This grants a bonus of +1 effective Hit Die for the purpose of resisting Channeling, spells, and other Hit-Die based effects only per 2 CP invested. It's most commonly found in the undead, but can be useful to any character at times.

Unity (6 CP). In worlds where Psychic powers and Magical effects are treated as distinct, non-interacting forces, a character with Unity has found a bridge between Psi and Magic. This character may treat them as aspects of the same thing. This primarily means that his or her psychic powers (or magic) interact with magic (or psychic powers), including dispels or anti-magic or anti-psychic fields. It also means that metamagic and meta-psionic abilities are interchangeable for him or her.

Wayfarer (6 CP). This allows the user to be a priest of an entire pantheon, force, or philosophy, rather than a given deity. In practical terms, it means that in games where the GM restricts spells from the normal lists based on the deity's personality (*i.e.*, the Ocean god doesn't give out *Flamestrike*), the priest may still use them. Similarly, you're much less likely to be assigned a quest, can use spells with any alignment descriptor regardless of your alignment, and generally don't have anyone keeping an judgmental eye on you. On the downside, there isn't anyone keeping an eye on you, so don't count on divine intervention.

Witchcraft (6-18 CP). Buying this feat gives you several powers under the Witchcraft rules. See page 109.

Workhorse (6 CP). Workhorse allows a character to reduce his or her effective encumbrance by one level.



*Can we get off the
Holodeck now, Captain?*

Proficiencies

Armor Proficiency. A character with Armor Proficiency knows how to use armor properly, has practiced moving in it, and can maintain it given the right supplies.

- Light Armor (3 CP) includes all armors listed as light.
- Medium Armor (+6 CP) requires Light Armor and includes all armors listed as light and medium.
- Heavy Armor (+6 CP) requires Medium Armor and includes all armors listed as light, medium, and heavy.
- Superheavy Armor (+6 CP) requires Heavy Armor and includes all armors listed as light, medium, and heavy, as well as superheavy armor, exotic forms, and peculiar materials.
- Shield Use (3 CP) includes all shields.
- *Smooth* doubles the total cost of any armor or shield proficiency (6 CP in total for Light, 18 for Light and Medium, etc) and allows the user to ignore armor check penalties and spell failure checks. You must buy Smooth for Light before Medium, and Medium before Heavy. It may also be applied to Shield Use.
- *Powered Armor* (+6 CP) allows the proper use of armor that has built-in strength amplification, movement modes, weapons, and other systems if you have proficiency with that armor's basic type. Do not include the cost for Powered Armor when purchasing Smooth.
- *Fast* (+6 CP) allows the user to don or remove armor in one round, regardless of its type.

Powered armor, obviously, leans more toward science-fiction games. Still, more than a few fantasy worlds have intelligent or animated armor.

Weapon Proficiency. Characters usually buy some sort of weapon proficiencies. It's a poor adventurer who can't even use a club to fight off some goblins. Unlike Armor Proficiencies these are listed with separate costs, both to cover the vast array of options and because there's a lot more variety in weapons skills than in the use of armor.

- Any one Simple Weapon (1 CP)
- Any one Martial Weapon (3 CP)
- Any one Exotic Weapon (6 CP)
- A small group of Simple Weapons (2 CP)
- All Simple Weapons (3 CP)
- All Simple Weapons and any one Martial Weapon (6 CP)
- All Simple and Martial Weapons (9 CP)
- All Simple and Martial Weapons plus any one Exotic Weapon (12 CP)
- All Simple, Martial, and Exotic Weapons (15 CP)
- Limited sets of Martial or Exotic weapons (such as those possessed by the Monk) cost 3 or more points, depending on how limited they are. The character must be able to use all simple weapons first. The list is subject to the GM's discretion. Common examples of limited sets include Bows and Crossbows (6 CP), Axes (6 CP),

Cultural Weapons (e.g., "Oriental Weapons," 9 CP), Blasters (All light, hand-held, energy weapons, 6 CP), Pistols (3 CP), and Small Arms (modern pistols and rifles, 6 CP).

- Gunnery (6 CP) covers all fixed-mount exotic weapons, from steam cannon to catapults to laser batteries.
- Elemental (6 CP) covers "throwers" (flame, acid, etc), and small-scale explosive devices such as grenades.
- Only the very first listed items (Any One ... Weapon) may be bought by characters after reaching level 2 unless they use the retraining option (page 18). Characters just can't suddenly master a variety of weapons after they've already molded their abilities.

- Bioweapons (6 CP) covers the offensive use of germs, biotoxins, vermin, and similar items.
- Economics (6 CP) covers hostile business takeovers, currency manipulation, unfair trade agreements and tariffs, and similar tactics*. Barbarians hate this.
- Gases (6 CP) covers the effective use of irritant, blistering, tissue-destroying, toxic, and lethal gases, as well as the use of counteragents and protective gear.
- Psychological Weapons (6 CP) covers satire, insults, whispering campaigns, leaflets, and other propaganda techniques*. It also stretches the idea of a weapon about as far as it will go.

**No, we aren't joking. Just use the normal combat rules on a slower scale if you want to use such exotic forms of "combat" and define "death" appropriately.*



Could someone help me out of this setup? I'm afraid to move.

Combat Enhancements

Anime Master (6 CP). Anime Master allows the user to grapple, overbear, and wield weapons, as if he or she was one size category larger.

Augment Attack (3 CP). Augment Attack grants +1d6 damage or +1 to hit in some specific situation (essentially, this feat is already “Specialized”), per 3 CP invested (a mere +1 damage costs 1 CP and +1d8 costs 4 CP). Characters may double the cost to make the situation relatively common or triple it to make it very common (e.g., with a particular type of weapon which you almost always use). No character may possess more than 36 CP worth of basic augmentations. The following upgrades may also be purchased:

- Crippling (+6 CP) makes attacks cause one point of ability damage. Characters must select the target ability when this ability is taken.
- Extended Range (+6 CP) adds +45’ to projectile weapon ranges or +60’ for thrown weapons.
- Continuing (+6 CP) lets an attack cause +1 point/round of damage until treated with an easy (DC 13) Heal check. It otherwise lasts up to twice the attacking character’s level in rounds.
- Silencing (+6 CP) keeps the target from speaking for one round.
- Disabling (+6 CP) reduces target’s movement by 10’ (to a minimum of 10’) for the duration of the encounter.
- If you want something else, make it up, and consult your Game Master to determine the cost.

Creatures which are immune to critical hits or who make a Fortification check are immune to extra damage or special Augment Attack effects. This does not apply if the bonus was purchased against such targets in the first place, such as “+3d6 damage versus undead” (relatively common, for 18 CP).

Game Masters may permit characters to purchase more than 36 CP worth of Augment Attack as long as the various bonuses apply to different situations.



It's all in the wrist.

Blind-Fight (6 CP). In melee, every time a character with Blind-Fight misses because of concealment, he or she may reroll his or her miss chance percentile roll once to see if he or she actually hits. He or she does not lose his or her Dex bonus to Armor Class, and the enemy doesn't get the usual +2 bonus, for being invisible. An

invisible enemy's bonuses do still apply for ranged attacks. In poor light, the user's speed slows to normal.

• Combat Awareness (+6 CP) prevents you from being flanked.

• Darksense (+3 CP) extends a character's Blind-Fight senses out to a 10' radius. For the purposes of the bonuses and penalties of Blind-fight this is the melee range. With ranged attacks the user takes no penalties due to lighting within this range.

• 30' Darksense (+3 CP) requires Darksense and extends a character's Blind-Fight senses out to a 30' radius. For the purposes of the bonuses and penalties of Blind-Fight,

this is the melee range. With ranged weapons the user takes no penalties due to lighting within this range.

• Sense of Perception (+6 CP) requires Darksense and allows the character to sense the structure of matter within the Darksense radius. The character can now feel matter, its divisions, and any empty spaces (or spaces filled with air or water). He or she can sense the internal mechanism of a lock and the heartbeats of living creatures. Creatures can still Hide from users, but the user gains a +10 bonus to find hidden doors and spaces.

Block (6 CP). Block lets a character counter an incoming attack with DC 20 Reflex save once per round. This must be bought on a limited category. In general, each Block attempt uses up an Attack of Opportunity and provides Great Immunity to the attack. Attackers may give up part of their BAB to increase the Block save DC on a 1-to-1 basis. The following three forms are the normal choices:

- Missile affects any thrown or projectile weapon.
- Melee affects any melee attack, including grapples.
- Arcane affects any single-target magic attack.
- Master (+6 CP) upgrades the roll, so that it requires only a DC 15 save.

- **Riposte** (+6 CP) allows the user to immediately retaliate in the same mode, launching a single attack of their own. This counts as an Attack of Opportunity and requires a successful Block check - which also counts as an Attack of Opportunity. You'll need extras.
- **Catch** (+6 CP) allows the user to grab a ranged weapon aimed at him or her out of the air and keep it with a successful block. If combined with Riposte, the user may retaliate with the attackers own weapon.
- **Deflections** (+12 CP) allows the user to catch individually-directed magical attacks to release on their action next round. This can be combined with Riposte to allow such spells to be retargeted against their casters.
- **Multiple** (+6 CP) allows the user to block 1 extra attack each round.

No, you can't take Bonus Uses on actions per round. This was actually asked.

- You may purchase this feat multiple times, each time for a different category of attack. Upgrades do not carry over from one instance to the next.

Bonus Attack (6 CP). The character chooses a specific weapon type, style, or situation, which grants one extra attack. The attack is made at the user's highest attack bonus, but all attack rolls are reduced by -2.

- **Improved** (+6 CP) reduces the penalties for your normal attack sequence by 2.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, choose a different situation OR increase the penalties for the new attack by -2, cumulative with previous penalties on new attacks. Upgrades do not carry over from one instance to the next.

Yes, this supersedes the standard rule for two-weapon combat. That's just a Corrupted version; you have to give up using a shield. Otherwise a character may use any weapon he or she can carry and effectively use: natural weapons and unarmed attacks, off-hand weapons, and shields.

Chain of Ki (6 CP). A martial arts technique with broad applications, this allows the use of a length of rope, cloth, or chain as a whip-like weapon without penalty. Such weapons inflict 1d4 (ribbons, string), 1d6 (rope, cloak, light chain, barbed whip), or 1d8 (spiked or heavy chain) points of damage and have reach.

- **Varying Grasp** (+6 CP) enables you to use the weapon as a plain melee weapon (or double weapon with two identical heads), using the Reach as needed. This incurs no attack penalty when attacking inside your Reach range.
- **Entangle** (+6 CP) enables you to use grapple as a ranged attack up to the Reach of your weapon. Both you and the target make checks normally. This deals no damage unless you wield a barbed whip or spiked chain. The target of the grapple cannot hurt you unless you are within his or her own reach.
- **Third Hand** (+6 CP) allows the weapon to manipulate items, as if it were your hand, up to its reach.

- **Animation** (+6 CP) requires Third Hand and turns any single, modestly-sized flexible item you're touching into a quasi-living thing, capable of acting and reacting (as per a small Animated Object that acts on your initiative) according to your desires even if you're unconscious. For +3 CP you may upgrade its base abilities to those of a medium Animated Object, and for another +6 to those of a large Animated Object.

- **Strengthen** (+6 CP) adds +10 Hardness and hit points to the rope, whip, cloth or chain. It also allows you to ignore leverage; your Strength is transmitted through whatever you're using.

Defender (6 CP). Defender adds a +(level/5 rounded down) bonus to your AC. The character selects the bonus type (Natural Armor, Dodge, or Deflection are the usual choices). The type determines what effects or situations will bypass it, and what magical effects fail, under the normal rules.

- **Improved** (+6 CP) adds +1 AC and may be taken multiple times. Characters don't actually *have* to take Defender first, although it is recommended.

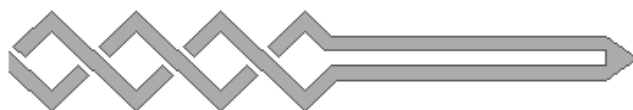
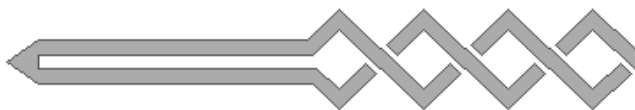
Many characters take a Corrupted version: not cumulative with armor and shield bonuses.

Doubled Damage (6 CP) The character must choose a very specific situation (this is difficult to Specialize further), in which he or she deals double damage from physical attacks. This situation must be so specific as to make the ability rare and difficult to use.

- For example, a common use is to affect only mounted charge attacks while wielding a lance or spear. This is difficult to do in most places, particularly in dungeons, buildings, mountains, forests, and cities, and so is suitable for Doubled Damage.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it covers a different situation.

Enhanced Strike (6 CP each). Enhanced Strike includes a variety of combat techniques mostly used by advanced characters. Each ability may be used once per minute. If the character desires, he or she may pay 3 Power, or 2 spell levels, or 1 Mana to use an ability more than once per minute, paying for each additional use. All are full attack options. A character may purchase as many versions of this ability as desired.

- **Crushing** applies all damage from an entire attack sequence as a single attack.
- **Focused** changes the attack to a touch attack.
- **Hurling** throws a weapon for double damage; this supersedes Doubled Damage. For an extra +3 CP, the weapon returns after the attack sequence.
- **Whirlwind** allows the user to make a single full-BAB attack against every target within reach.
- **Hammer** allows the attack to deal maximum damage while gaining a +5 bonus to hit.
- **Shattering** ignores half the total hardness when the character attacks an object.



Evasive. Evasive characters may take an action (select one) that usually provokes an Attack of Opportunity without being so exposed. You may take this multiple times, selecting a different action each time.

- Uncommon Actions (3 CP) such as Bull Rush, Disarm, Sunder or Attack an Object (carried by another), or Grapple are cheap.
- Common Actions (6 CP), such as use the Heal skill, retrieving stored items, Coup De Grace, or throwing a weapon, cost more.
- Very Common Actions (12 CP) such as using projectile weapons in melee, casting spells, moving by opponents in the threatened area, fleeing combat, or using spell-like abilities cost a lot.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it covers a different situation and/or action.

Far Shot (6 CP). Far Shot multiplies projectile weapon ranges by x1.5 and thrown weapon ranges by x2. This may be taken multiple times.

Favored Enemy (6 CP, 3.0 Version). With Favored Enemy, the character selects a type of enemy, either by species or by type (although “humanoids” isn’t allowed for no known reason). This brings a bonus of +(level/4) to damage and on Listen, Sense Motive, Spot, and Survival skill rolls versus the chosen foe. The character adds another foe type at a -1 (cumulative each time) penalty whenever the bonus rises.

Favored Enemy and Favored Foe do not stack.



Yeah. Favored Foe: Trees. So?

Favored Foe (6 CP, 3.5 Version). A character with Favored Foe may select an enemy creature type at levels 1, 5, 10, 15, 20, and so on, gaining +2 to damage and on Listen, Sense Motive, Spot, and Survival checks when using these skills against a chosen enemy creature type. Each time a new foe is added the character may select one of his or her foes (including the one just chosen) and increase his or her bonuses against that foe type by +2.

Favored Enemy and Favored Foe do not stack.

Favored Enemy and Foe Types

Type (Subtype)	Type (Subtype)
Aberration	Humanoid (reptilian)
Animal	Magical beast
Construct	Monstrous humanoid
Dragon	Ooze
Elemental	Outsider (air)
Fey	Outsider (chaotic)
Giant	Outsider (earth)
Humanoid (aquatic)	Outsider (evil)
Humanoid (dwarf)	Outsider (fire)
Humanoid (elf)	Outsider (good)
Humanoid (goblinoid)	Outsider (lawful)
Humanoid (gnoll)	Outsider (native)
Humanoid (gnome)	Outsider (water)
Humanoid (halfling)	Plant
Humanoid (human)	Undead
Humanoid (orc)	Vermin

Favored Enemy and Favored Foe pull a fast one there. Why should a four-armed unholy monster from the depths of Heck, a slime creature from the abyssal mire, and an evil alien swarm-mind all fall in one category (Evil Outsider), while humans, elves, and dwarves are too different? At the least, it ought to be arranged by the creature’s body type or affiliation. In the latter case, the character targets members of a particular group: the Order of Doom, or the servants of Demon Lord Belal. While we included it for back-compatibility, we don’t really recommend using the standard type list.

Possible variants on Favored -Enemy and -Foe are legion, and usually simply reassign a few of the bonuses or alter the “type” list. A beastmaster might want bonuses on Handle Animal (or whatever) and Heal instead of on damage and Sense Motive. A diplomat might want to take favored cultures instead of types, gaining a bonus on Diplomacy and Knowledge skills instead of on Survival and damage. Explorers might want to take terrain types instead of creature types, gaining bonuses to Hide and Move Silently instead of Sense Motive and damage. Scholars might want to take specific regions or periods, gaining bonuses to Appraise, Decipher Script, relevant Knowledge skills (counted as two or three of their bonuses), and possibly Use Magic Device. Thieves might want to pick favored cities, gaining bonuses to Appraise, Gather Information, Hide, Move Silently, and Knowledge: Local while there. Those



who hunt particular monsters might want to take extra bonuses against them and their particular attacks. You can even favor particular instruments, individual spells (to increase the save DC, damage, etc), or declared heretics and enemies of your church.

Used this way a somewhat illogical ability can become a powerful and sensible tool for customizing characters, without expending large amounts of CP (or feats and levels) on abilities which are often of little use.

Fortune (6 CP). The ever-useful Fortune feat gives the character the ability to entirely ignore certain effects on a successful save. If a spell or effect has an entry such as “Fort Partial” or “Ref half,” this feat works.

- *Evasion* covers Reflex saves.
- *Impervious* covers Fortitude saves.
- *Defiant* covers Will saves.
- *Improved* (+6 CP) upgrades the ability so that the character takes half damage or effect even on an unsuccessful save. Alternatively, for many Will or Fort saves, half duration may be appropriate.
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it affects a different saving throw. Upgrades do not carry over.

Imbuement (6 CP). Once taken, the user defines this for a specific weapon type or for unarmed attacks.

- Weapons gain a $+(level/4)$ enhancement bonus to hit and damage. This does not stack with a magic weapon's bonuses.
- Unarmed attacks receive a $+(level/7)$ enhancement bonus to hit and damage, but may take special weapon powers or spend a “+1” to count as being of a special material without the Focused upgrade. Characters with the Spirit Weapon feat may select either the weapon or unarmed version to apply to that weapon when they take Imbuement.
- *Improved* (+6 CP) reduces the divisor for the weapon formula to 3 and to the unarmed formula to 5. The weapon formula becomes $+(level/3)$ and the unarmed formula $+(level/5)$.
- *Superior* (+6 CP, requires Improved) reduces the divisor for the weapon formula to 2 and to the unarmed formula to 3. The weapon formula becomes $+(level/2)$ and the unarmed formula $+(level/3)$.
- *Focused* (+6 CP) allow the user to change “plusses” into specific magic weapon powers. Once spent on a specific power (such as Holy or Shocking Burst), the user may not reclaim the “plusses.” You may also count your weapon as any given special material for a plus.
- *Versatile* (+6 CP) requires the Focused upgrade and allows characters to reclaim and reallocate “plusses” given 8 hours to rest.

Improved Critical (6 CP). Improved Critical doubles a specific weapon's critical threat range.

- *Superior* (+6 CP) allows the character to add personal critical range improvements to a single magical one. Use

the standard rules for adding multipliers. Do not stack increases directly.

For example, a character who doubles his or her threat range through this feat and triples it through a spell would have a total threat range multiplied by $\times 4$.

- *Lethal* (+6 CP) increases the critical multiplier by +1.
- You may purchase this feat multiple times. Each time, it affects another weapon. Upgrades do not carry over.

Improved Initiative (3 CP). The character gains +2 to Initiative per 3 CP invested, up to a maximum +8 bonus.

The maximum is intended for the players' benefit, so as to avoid pitting them in massive Initiative races against monsters.

Improvise Weapon (3 CP). With Improvise Weapon, a character may pick up and wield any item he or she can handle as a weapon or shield with statistics identical to manufactured weapons. Most items equate to clubs, daggers, staves, or mauls of various types.

- *Surprise Strike* (+6 CP) lets the user select one opponent, who is then considered flat-footed against the user for one round. This works once per combat encounter.

Legionary (6 CP). A Legionary has great coordination when fighting in a team. The character gains $+1/2/3$ bonus to AC, Attacks and Reflex Saves when teamed with $1-2/3-4/5+$ others with who also possess this feat.

Lunge (6 CP). Add +5 feet to your effective reach. Creatures with tentacles, stretching powers, or very long limbs may take this more than once.

Maneuver (6 CP). You may use the Tumble skill in combat to try to evade an Attack of Opportunity 1/round, with a DC equal to the attack roll.

Martial Arts (3 CP). A character is considered armed when using unarmed combat so long as he or she places at least 3 CP in this ability. He or she gains a base damage of 1d4 with unarmed attacks. Each +3 CP invested after that increases the damage by one die type (d6/d8/d10/d12), up to a maximum of 1d12 at 15 CP.

- Characters possessing 1d12 damage may opt to invest +6 CP to move the damage to 1d20 or 2d10 depending on preference.
- In martial-arts based games, the GM should allow other characters to increase base weapon damage using this progression.
- Characters or creatures with natural or spirit weapons may increase the die type in the same fashion.
- The user's size has no effect on his or her martial arts damage. Go ahead. Make that mighty pixie martial artist.

A distinct and unrelated skill called Martial Arts appears in Chapter 3. Sorry, we ran out of names again.





If the sword is my soul...does using it count as unarmed combat?

Occult Combat (3+ CP). This talent grants the use of one psionic or mystic combat mode (with a dramatic name of choice) for every 3 CP invested. Each uses and attacks an attribute chosen when this ability is taken. The user and target make opposed (D20 + Attribute Mod + Will Save Bonus) checks (Wis Mod may apply to both). If the target loses he or she takes 1d4 points of damage to the attribute attacked (Con may not be reduced below 1 in this fashion). Such attacks have a range of 60 feet and cost 4 Power, 2 spell levels, or 1 Mana to launch. Upgrades apply to all modes.

- *Improved* (+6 CP) boosts the damage done to 1d4+2 attribute points.
- *Drain* (+6 CP) is an advanced mode that uses opposed will saves only: if the target loses he or she is drained of spell levels (at 1 for 1) or power (at 2 for 1) instead of attribute points. The target may decide what specific spells or reserves are lost but the user may decide which effect, spell levels or Power, to apply if the target has both. The Improved modifier applies normally.
- *Area* (+12 CP) allows the user to affect either a 60' cone or a 20' radius within range. Using either doubles the cost of the attack. The second option may be added for another +6 CP.

- *Entrap* (+6 CP) requires Drain and pulls 1d2 spell levels (1d4 with Improved) or 1d8 Power (1d10 with Improved) from a successful attacker using Occult Combat. It is otherwise like Drain.
- *Vampire* (+6 CP) requires Drain and allows the user to personally absorb half the spell levels or Power drained from the target via the Drain or Entrap options. It grants no special ability to use said energy.
- *Occult Armor* (+6 CP) protects the character from mystic or psionic ability drains. The character is not affected by Drain unless he or she fails the opposed saving throw by 10 points or more. At the GM's option, the character might be immune to similar minor ability drains (i.e., 0-2nd level spells or weak side effects of stronger spells) unless he or she fails the save by a similar margin.

Classical psionic combat employs five basic attack modes (15 CP), Area (Specialized in one mode, 3 CP), Occult Armor (Specialized: costs 1 power per point absorbed, 3 CP), Blessing (Radius, Specialized: may extend Occult Armor to a 5' radius for 2 Power/round, 6 CP), and a +1 on Will Saves (3 CP), for a total of 30 CP.

Overwhelm (6 CP). A character with this may choose to use Overwhelm Attacks. These function exactly as normal attacks but can drive opponents back 5 feet. Enemies resist as per Bull Rush. Note that this renders any subsequent attacks without a ranged weapon useless that round if it succeeds. Reach allows for subsequent attacks as well.

Rapid Strike (6 CP). Normally, characters attack every 5 BAB steps. With Rapid Strike, they may select one specific weapon type (or unarmed attacks), and use that attack every 4 steps instead. (BAB +20/16/12/8/4)

- *Improved* (+12 CP) grants the ability to attack every 3 BAB steps. (BAB +20/17/14/11/8/5/2)
- *Superior* (+18 CP) grants the ability to attack every 2 BAB steps. (BAB +20/18/16/14/12/10/8/6/4/2)
- You may take this ability multiple times. Each time, it affect a different weapon. Upgrades do not carry over from one instance to the next.

The Rapid Strike ability allows for some gross overkill with high-level characters. Be careful about allowing the higher end versions unless you're prepared for this. Of course, the monsters can do it too, but this can rapidly overwhelm less combative characters.

Smite (6 CP). The character adds his or her Charisma Modifier to Hit, and level to damage, against a chosen type of foe 1/day. Most characters take this with Bonus Uses. See page 52 for some possible enemy types.

Specialist (3 CP). Specialist grants a +4 bonus on any one of the following checks: Grapple, Trip, Sunder, Disarm, Strength-based Overrun checks, or another specialty attack the GM allows.

Spirit Weapon (6 CP for melee, 9 CP for ranged). With Spirit Weapon, the character may manifest a personal-use weapon which does subdual or lethal damage. The character picks either subdual or physical, not both, and the user also chooses slashing, piercing, crushing, a magical energy type, or a non-magical energy for the damage type. Most characters who take this also purchase Imbuement (page 53). The weapon may be any the user is proficient with including unarmed strikes. Unarmed strikes bought with the Spirit Weapon power are considered armed attacks. Spirit Weapon damage may be upgraded as per Martial Arts.

- Nonmagical energy works in antimagic fields and the like, but has a disadvantage. Targets with normal insulating clothing (leather for electricity, asbestos for fire, wool for cold, etc.) have resistance 5. Metal armors normally do not insulate.

- **Switch** (+3 CP) enables a character to do either stun or lethal damage at will. For each additional +3 CP the user may add an additional type of damage to his or her repertoire.

- **Touch Attack** (+6 CP) enables the character to make touch attacks rather than normal ones. Note that this costs (+6 CP) per attack per round so upgraded, not (+6 CP) for all attacks together.

- **Exotic Appearance** (+3 CP) upgrades the Spirit Weapon to look like almost anything the user desires, such as "Bolts of Black Lighting" rather than a short bow.

The Evil Space Emperor leered, menacingly "And now, young Skyhopper, you will die!" The Emperor laughed hideously and pulled out a laser rifle, firing wildly at Skyhopper. The Black Knight looked askance at the Evil Space Emperor, quickly deciding that anyone who wasn't willing to spend 3 CP for a decent special effect was far too cheap to rule the cosmos.



I took Exotic Appearance!

What do you mean "It goes on the weapon?"

Split Movement (6 CP). The user selects a specific type of action (like attacking or spellcasting) He or she may then split his or her movement up into sections before and after that type of action. Consider each move separately. He or she does not gain any bonus for using Move-Equivalent Actions and may not use more of them than he or she normally could.

The Game Master may want to draw a distinction between ranged and melee attacks, schools of magic, or disciplines, making this ability much more specific.

Throwing Master (6 CP). With Throwing Master, the character may throw any object he or she can pick up with one hand, with a basic range of 10' (20' for light, aerodynamic items) for 1d4 (lethal) bludgeoning damage, or its usual base damage, whichever is higher. Again, the damage may be increased as per Martial Arts.

Trick (6 CP). You may make a special attack under Specialized circumstances or 3/day, which forces a save and causes a dangerous special effect. The usual DC stands at 10 +(1/2 your level) +(any one relevant attribute modifier). This usually uses Intelligence or Dexterity, but anything's possible.

- Death Attack kills the target after the Trick-user studies the victim for 3 rounds, if the victim fails a Fort save. Death Attack usually uses the Intelligence bonus.

- Stun Attack forces the victim to make a Ref save or becomes Stunned for 3

rounds. You may either use this 3/day or under specific circumstances. Stun Attack usually uses Dexterity bonus.

- Note that Death attacks, Fear attacks, Paralysis, or any other power which takes the target out of the fight all have the same cost. Essentially, a Trick can take a target enemy out of the fight. In d20, this is as effective as killing outright. Attacks which merely inflict a penalty, such as entanglement, temporarily hindering movement, or temporary blindness will either be more easily usable or can be considered Corrupted.

While a Death Attack is slightly more useful, it remains slightly less versatile due to the time requirement - and the inability to ask questions later.

Metamagical Theorems

Spellcasters may produce many powerful effects, but few can claim to really understand magic. Those who study metamagic have at least begun to do so, as they learn to manipulate the inner structure of spells.

Early metamagic techniques soon multiplied beyond what any spellcaster could keep track of, much less master. Most, however, are simply individual applications of one of the general metamagic theorems listed below.

The metamagic feats listed below aren't limited to just the effects mentioned here. Reasonable requests for variants should be honored, although the Game Master will almost certainly have to quash overly potent effects and is encouraged to experiment until he or she finds a good balance for a particular effect's level modifier.

While characters can build the same modifiers into a spell's original design whether or not they possess the theorem in question, it's often more useful to have a basic effect and many potential modifiers to match any situation.

One of the classic metamagic feats, Heighten, no longer exists. In this system, any spell caster may use a spell in a higher-level slot, and gain all the benefits thereof. This does not apply to level increases paid toward metamagic effects. The only real benefit is the increase in save DC, and we feel this ought not to require a feat. Of course, some GM's may disagree, but we still suggest that it cost no more than 3 CP. That is just a variant of an ability they already possess: putting low level spells in high-level slots.

All metamagic feats can stack with each other and there is no upper limit on the number of spell levels that can be invested in any one feat; putting in more levels simply results in a higher-order variant on the basic effect.



And now, for only +1 spell level, we bring you...

Metamagic and Metapsionic effects are equivalent. +1 SL corresponds to +2 Power as per the normal rules. The Game Master may or may not require that they be developed separately, depending on the nature of magic and psionics in the campaign.

Amplify (6 CP). You know how to increase the raw power of your spells. Common applications include:

- **Augment** (+2 levels) adds +50% to the damage or other effect inflicted.
- **Maximize** (+3 SL) automatically gets the maximum value for damage or other random effects. Spells with variable effects, such as *Confusion* allow the caster to select the effect.

- **Double Effect** (+4 SL) simply doubles the effect inflicted.

- **Double Maximized** (+7 SL) maximizes *and* doubles a spell's effects. Obviously, this trick can exceed a given spell's normal maximum damage by far, but few casters can use it.

Area (6 CP). You know how to increase the area of effect of your spells. Common applications include:

- **Area** (+1 SL) adds +50% to the existing area or radius of a spell.

- **Boost** (+2 SL) improves the spell, changing Ray to Cone (same range) or Touch to a 10' radius.

- **Hammer** (+2 SL) doubles a spell's radius, the length of a

cone, or any similar measurement.

- **Ray Burst** (+3 SL) causes a Ray to affect a 30' radius, with those within 10' receiving no save.

- **Boundless** (+8 SL) allows a spell to affect an entire battlefield. For example, a *Magic Missile* cast with the Boundless modifier would inflict 5d4+5 force damage to every enemy on an entire battlefield.

- **Regional** (+12 SL) allows a spell to affect an entire state, region, or small continent.

- **Grandiose** (+20 SL) allows a spell to affect an entire planet, pocket dimension, demiplane, or similarly-sized realm.

We recommend against doing this with Fireball and similar spells. You usually live there, too.

Battle Magic (6 CP). Battle Magic, unique among metamagic, does not add levels to spells. It has other, more expensive, requirements. Note that if the spell does not include the ability to specifically target individuals it will affect every valid target in its area of effect. This includes the caster(s). Beware using attack magic with this, as it tends to destroy everything and everybody in range.

Area spells, while especially dangerous, do not strike any one target multiple times, unless this is a normal feature of the spell or was added through metamagic.

- **Battlefield** allows a character with a dozen aides (usually minor spellcasters themselves), a trunk full of gear worth 1000 GP, and 20 rounds to cast a spell affecting a massive area (10x to 20x the normal scale, targeting units instead of individuals). This can also be used to enhance the effective Caster Level by up to +12 (+1 per available assistant) instead of expanding the scale. This is mostly used when creating static wards or for long-term projects.

- **Epic** allows a character with one month, a major power source (usually an artifact with abilities related to the spell to be cast) and 10,000 GP worth of gear to cast a spell affecting an entire state or region.

- **Universal** allows a character with a year or more to kill and a point of Godfire (see page 76) to craft a spell which affects an entire planet or similarly sized world.

Only Gods normally have access to Godfire. Still, some spellcaster might have been granted a point as a boon, find one entrapped in an artifact, or be working with some minor deity.

Compact (6 CP). You have learned to reduce the level of spells by adding special requirements and components to their casting. In general, no matter how many conditions are added, spells cannot have their base level reduced by more than 3. Another 3 levels' worth of conditions can be used to compensate for other metamagics, however.

Unfortunately, what conditions may be applied to any given spell or in any given world must be left to the discretion of the Game Master. The following list should cover most possibilities.

- (-1 SL) Taking 10 times the usual casting time. Assume that this modifier has already been applied to any spell with a casting time of one minute or more. Using the Easy/Temporal metamagic on such a spell requires buying off this bonus first.

- (-1 SL) Using expensive components or foci. Spells that already require such things have this modifier applied already.

- (-1 SL) Calling on a friendly extraplanar patron with powers similar to the spell (and owing them a minor favor). Most major divine magic already includes this modifier.

- (-1 SL) Spending 10-200 XP. Spells which already cost XP already include this modifier.

- (-1 SL) Taking 1d4 points of attribute damage from the casting.
- (-1 SL) Taking 1d6 damage per level of the spell in casting it (use the base level of the spell).
- (-1 SL) Becoming exhausted when you cast it.
- (-1 SL) Drastically reducing the range, duration, and/or area of effect.
- (-1 SL) Working at an appropriate time or place of power for the type of magic you're invoking.
- (-2 SL) Taking days or weeks to cast. This supersedes the -1 SL time modifier. Only -1 SL for spells which normally take a minute or more to cast.
- (-2 SL) Using outrageously elaborate or expensive spell components, such as a large temple. This supersedes expensive components, above.
- (-2 SL) Spending 201-1000 XP. See above.
- (-2 SL) Undertaking a quest for an extraplanar patron with similar powers in exchange for their help (only -1 level for divine spellcasters).
- (-3 SL) Spending 1001-5000 XP. See above.
- (-4 SL) Dying to cast it. (*Raise Dead* still works.)
- (-5 SL) Being crippled or horribly, and nearly irrevocably, cursed to cast it.
- (-6 SL) Dying irreversibly to cast it.

Easy (6 CP). You have learned to substitute raw power for some of the usual requirements of your spells. Common applications of this technique include:

- **Material** (+1 SL) removes the need for most material components unless they're integral to the spell effect. If you have a spell which animates a sword to fight, you still need the sword. However, you won't need ruby dust to sprinkle it with.

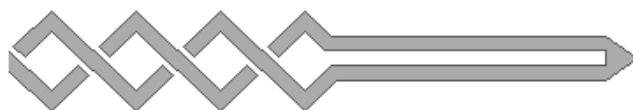
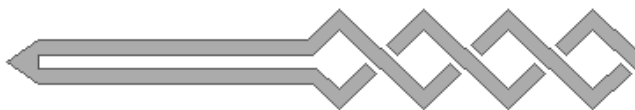
The classic Eschew Materials feat does not increase the spell level, but only works on materials and only for those costing 1 GP or less. If you want that version, it's bought as Easy, with the Streamline metamagical modifier, Specialized to materials costing 1 GP or less only, for a total of 6 CP.

- **Verbal** (+1 SL) removes the need for incantations.

- **Somatic** (+1 SL) removes the need for gestures and arcane spell failure chance.

- **Temporal** (+1 SL) allows the caster to use the spell as a Free Action. Unfortunately, since you can't take any time to speak, gesture, or get out components, you must also apply the Material, Verbal, and Somatic effects for a total of +4 spell levels. Using this effect on spells with lengthy casting times requires another +1 SL, +2 SL if the normal casting time is measured in hours or more.

The classic Quicken feat states that "you can cast a spell with a moment's thought." It isn't quite clear as to what this means or whether it effectively includes the Silent Spell and Still Spell feats; official and unofficial statements seem to go both ways. If you feel that the +4 level cost does not include one more of the earlier effects simply increase the spell level adjustment for Temporal by the number you do not include.



Elemental Manipulation (6 CP). Elemental Manipulation allows the user to add additional energy types to a spell. Possible effects here include:

- **Alter** (+0 SL) changes the elemental effect of a spell from one type to another.
- **Subdual** (+1 SL) changes the damage from lethal to subdual or vice versa.
- **SFX** (+1 SL) changes special effects so that the spell looks and/or sounds different or even takes effect invisibly. Inherently obvious spells such as *Meteor Swarm* or *Call Lightning* may require +2 to +3 SL. This is the same general effect as Lacing: Hidden.
- **Ether** (+1 SL) makes the spell affect Ethereal creatures. Similar modifiers apply for other coexistent planes or extradimensional spaces. For +2 SL all such planes and spaces can be affected simultaneously.
- **Infliction** (+1 to +5 SL) causes the spell to inflict a condition on those who fail to resist. Such conditions normally last for one round per level of the spell. The SL adjustment depends on what condition is inflicted.

(+1 SL): Blown Away, Dazed (1 round), Dazzled, Deafened, Fatigued, Knocked Down, or Sickened

(+2 SL): Blinded, Confused, Energy Drained (1 level, lasts 1 hour per Caster Level, max 20), Entangled, Exhausted, Frightened, or Shaken

(+3 SL): Cowering, Nauseated, Panicked, or Stunned

(+4 SL): Paralyzed or Unconscious

(+5 SL): Dead, Petrified

- **Concussive** (+2 SL) causes the spell to toss those affected out of the way (either out of the area of effect or 10 feet per level of the spell), knocking them prone and inflicting damage as if they had fallen an equal distance.

- **Holy/Unholy** (+2 SL) makes half the damage Sacred or Profane. The spell gains the Good or Evil subtype as appropriate. No, you can't add both.

- **Twining** (+2 SL) adds secondary elemental effects at half of a base elemental effect. This effectively increases a spell's damage by +50%.

- **Improved Twining** (+4 SL) adds a secondary elemental effect at full power for +4 spell levels. This effectively doubles a spell's damage.

- **Sacred/Profane** (+4 SL) changes the damage to Sacred or Profane damage as appropriate.



It's 12 CP. Do you want it or not?

Extension (6 CP). Extension covers the fine art of manipulating the range of spells. Common applications include:

- **Extension** (+1 SL per step) increases the range of a spell from Touch to Short, Short to Medium, Medium to Long, Long to Extreme (800 ft + 80 ft/Level), and Extreme to Line of Sight (limited only by the user's direct vision).
- **Indirect Fire** (+2 SL) allows the spell to hit targets within range which the user is aware of but cannot see; this is not compatible with Line of Sight.
- **Global** (+6 SL) amplifies the range so that it may hit any known target on a planet (or in the atmosphere).
- **Trans-dimensional** (+8 SL) allows the user to target through scrying effects, to hit targets across the dimensional boundary, or to target people at interstellar ranges. Strangely, Trans-dimensional doesn't take any more time to reach the target than normal.

Lacing (6 CP). Lacing is the art of weaving in counter-counter measures. While rare and difficult, it can make spells almost unstoppable.

- **Hidden** (+1) uses a subtle Illusion effect to hide spells that are already subtle or quiet. The spell has no visible or audible effect.

- **Improved Hidden** (+3 SL) is required to hide spells that otherwise would be flashy, noisy, or otherwise wildly obvious.

- **Penetrating** (Variable) allows the caster to better overcome Spell Resistance, providing a +3 on the roll per +1 SL applied.

- **Brackish** (+2 SL) renders the spell unabsorbable by items that can absorb and store spells or spell levels. It does not stop character abilities.

- **Improved Brackish** (+4 SL) renders the spell unabsorbable by character abilities as well as items.

- **Bypass** (+1 to +4 SL) allows a spell to bypass special immunities, such as an

undead's resistance to mind-altering effects or a golem's magical immunity. The caster must specify which defense when he or she prepares this spell, or casts it (for Spontaneous casters). The GM must adjudicate the SL cost as needed. The more powerful and less specific the immunity, the more it costs to use Bypass.

- **Dispelling** counters defensive spells that would otherwise immunize the target against the spell cast with Lacing. Increasing the SL by +2/4/6/8 counters a spell of up to level 4/8/12/16.



Multiple (6 CP). You have learned how to combine multiple spells into one. Common applications of this technique include:

- **Combine**. You may stuff a number of spell levels into a single spell slot equal to the (slot level -1) and cast them as one effect. Thus, several low level spells can go off with one casting. The spells do not need the same target, duration, or any other attribute. The sole exception is if the caster uses a spell slot with inherent limitations on it such as those possessed by a Wizard with school specialization. In that case, every spell within the slot must meet every requirement of the slot.
- **Spamming** repeats a spell multiple times.. The cost is equal to (+2 SL + the number of times the character desires the spell to activate). This cost is reduced by 1 if the spell takes effect once per round instead of all going off at once and by 2 if the user must "recast" each successive repetition on successive rounds.

For example, a Fireball that takes effect four times would cost +6 spell levels. If only one goes off per round, it's +5. If you have to keep casting, it's only +4.

- The **Chain** variant (+3 SL) jumps from target to target, just like the 3.0 *Chain Lightning* spell. It homes in on the nearest available valid target, then strikes the next. GM's and players should use some caution with this power, as it tends to go out of control. This effect reduces the effective Caster Level by 1 per jump.

Some spells, such as Charm Monster, may not be suitable and the GM can ban them or increase the cost. Reduce this option to +2 SL if the spell only jumps once per round.

- **Bump** (+4 SL), similar to Chain, lets spells hit the primary target, then affect one secondary target per Caster Level at half power. Reduce this option to +3 SL if the spell only takes effect once per round.

Persistent (6 CP). You have learned how to extend the duration of your spells. The available effects include:

- **Persistent** (+1 SL) makes spells last longer, doubling the duration.
- **Improved Persistent** allows the user to add +2/3/4 levels to change the duration from hours/a few hours/a few minutes to 24-hours. This can only make the duration 24 hours long.

After using Improved Persistent, a character may make a spell last for a week with another +2 SL, for a month with +4 SL, for a year with +8 SL, or permanent until dispelled or cancelled for +12 SL.

- **Sacrifice** lets you make a spell with a duration truly permanent in a different fashion; you must permanently sacrifice a spell slot three levels higher than the level of the spell in question. It then becomes an innate ability and remains in effect permanently as a supernatural power. Note that this does not mean that you can keep casting it; if you give up a sixth level spell slot to gain the ability to *Fly* indefinitely, you can't grant that ability to other people.

Sculpting (6 CP). You have learned to manipulate the shape and targeting of your spells. Common effects include:

- **Shaping** (+1 SL) allows the caster to change an area-effect spell into a predetermined, specifically shaped area of effect with the same volume as it normally has.
- **Instant Shaping** (+2 SL) instead shapes the spell as above while casting.
- **Personal Immunity** (+1 SL) renders the spellcaster immune to his or her own magical area effects.
- **Targeting** (+3 SL) lets you select which targets within the area of effect will actually be affected, exempting anyone you please.
- **Precision** adds a +10/+15/+20 Insight bonus on the attack roll for ranged touch spells for +1/2/3 spell levels.

Stabilize (6 CP). You can make your spells sustain themselves. Common effects using this technique include:

- **Attend** (+1 SL) lets a spell which normally requires concentration sustain itself for up to (Cha Mod +1) rounds, after which time the caster must concentrate on it for one round before it can be left on it's own again.
- **Stabilize** (+2 SL) removes the need to concentrate on spells. Spells or powers which normally require concentration instead run automatically. The user must concentrate to actually control the spell.
- **Obliging** (+3 SL) allows a spell to both maintain and control itself according to what the caster would want it to do. The player can still control the spell even if the character is unconscious or dead. Spells which do not require concentration to maintain may be rendered obliging for only +1 SL.

Transference (6 CP). You have learned how to transfer magic to others. Some possible effects here include:

- **Grant** (+0 SL) allows you to lend someone else one of your prepared or spontaneous spells (chosen at the time you grant it) to use when they need it. You may not regain the slot until it's used.
- **Giveaway** (+1 SL) allows you to hand over control and concentration on a spell to another character after casting it.
- **Sharing** (+2 SL) allows you to use a spell with a range of self-only on another friendly character.
- **True Grant** (+3 SL) allows spells to originate from another character who is both within the caster's line of sight and the spell's basic range (120 feet minimum).
- **Great Grant** (+4 SL) allows spells to originate from anybody the caster is in mental contact with.
- **Grand Blessing** (+6 SL) allows you to grant a spell to someone else and still regain it normally. Unfortunately, no one recipient can carry more than (Con) levels of imbued spells, the limit includes the +6 spell levels, and the spells dissipate in a week. Most people can only carry one spell.



Transference is a wonderful way for your villains to strike at the heroes - or unsuspecting victims - without exposing themselves to harm - and, of course, they'll be much more powerful in person.

Triggering (6 CP). You can set up delays or activation conditions and program your spells to choose between options on their own. Triggering options normally persist for 24 hours, except where noted otherwise.

- **Holding** keeps a touch spell ready while you do something else for up to 10 minutes. This costs no spell levels, although spontaneous casters do have the casting time extended as usual.

- **Simple Conditions** (+1 SL) or a time delay costs +1 spell level. This includes "Activate on command," "Wait ten minutes," and "When the next group of people come by."

- **Complex Conditions** (+2 SL) allow the caster to use multiple Simple triggers at once.

- **Programmed Conditions** (+3 SL) allow the caster to set up contingent effects (or several contingent effects) with a specified target, such as "Activate when I reach half my hit points."

- **Mobile Focus** (+1 SL) allows the spell to locate and select targets on its own initiative. These spells have a +0 ranged attack bonus, should it matter. This includes "Fire yourself at my enemies chasing after me past the obelisk." Also, this anchors the spell to a physical item which can be moved or left behind, whereas the previous versions either kept the spell near the caster or at a specific location.

- **Clockwise** (+1 SL) adds to the time limit. Casters may relax the limit by an additional 24 hours with Extension. This doesn't increase the spell's duration, but will allow a trigger to remain active for longer. The caster may stack as many of these as he or she can afford.



General Metamagical Upgrades

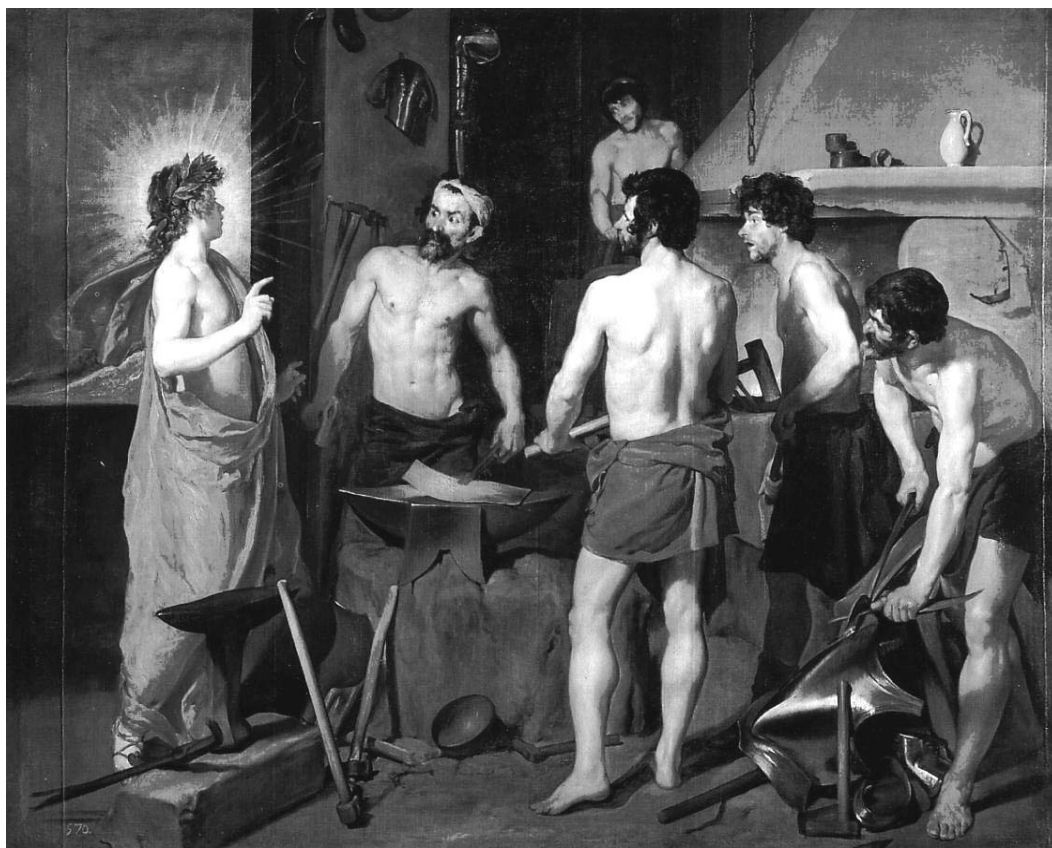
This category includes upgrades applicable to any of the feats presented previously.

Glory. (6 CP) Once Glory is applied to a metamagic theorem the character may use it spontaneously, adding up to +(Con Mod) spell levels worth of the effect to a spell up to (Con Mod) times per day. This boost doesn't allow any other metamagic feat, even if the character has more spell levels left over. Casters who prepare spells may still use this effect spontaneously, but the +(Con Mod) must cover the whole cost of the metamagic that they wish to add unless they've prepared the spell in a higher-level (but insufficient) slot.

- **Improved Glory** (+12 CP) allows the character to use any metamagic feat he or she knows in this way, or any combination of such feats.

Streamline. (6 CP) A favored ability for casters, this reduces the level cost of any two metamagic feats by -1. Casters may take this more than once, but cannot reduce the level cost below 0.

Fast. (6 CP) For spontaneous spellcasters, Fast allows the use all known metamagic feats without increasing the casting time. In general, this replaces any special preparation feats.



How many times must I tell you this? Glory, then Streamline!



Templates & Racial Abilities

Templates are designed much like character levels, but do not include a base hit die. Since this has an effective value of 8 CP, a +1 ECL is worth 32 points. Character races built on 31 points or less, like the standard races, do not call for an ECL adjustment.

Point Cost	Level Adjustment
0-31	(No level adjustment)
32-63	+1 ECL
64-95	+2 ECL
96-127	+3 ECL
128-169	+4 ECL
160-191	+5 ECL

The abilities listed below aren't usually available after character creation; they're mostly used in creating templates and creatures.

Amorphous (6 CP). Your body has no definite form, and can squeeze through cracks, into oddly-shaped spaces. You cannot be flanked since you have no facing, implicit or otherwise.

Amorphous characters usually also purchase immunity to the extra damage from critical hits and non-flanking sneak attacks. This is not required though.

Attribute Shift (6 CP). You may apply a +2 bonus to one attribute at the cost of applying a -2 modifier to another. No single attribute may be changed by more than 6 in this way.

Energy Infusion (6 CP). Your body is partially made up of extra-dimensional or elemental energies rather than mere flesh. This has several different effects:

- You are immune to damage or harmful effects derived from the energy type you're infused with.
- You can easily survive in environments made up from the energy type you're infused with.
- You take double damage from the opposing energy type. While others are possible, likely energy sets and pairs include the *Elemental* (Fire [Fire] and Water [Cold] or Earth [Acid] and Air [Lightning]), *Alignment* (Good [Sacred] and Evil [Profane] or Chaos [Sonic] and Law [Force]), and *Planar* (Positive and Negative Energy or Ethereal [Force] and Shadow [Illusion]). Some Game Masters may also allow the *Forces* (Darkness and Light or Gravity and Nuclear Energies). Truly odd Game Masters may allow the *Primordial Energies* - (Astral [Mind-Affecting] and Blood [Poison] or Dimensional and Cosmological), but most sages claim that they don't exist anyway.
- You acquire the appropriate type (Fire, Lawful, etc.) and can be affected by spells and abilities which target that type or types.

- You may take Energy Infusion more than once, as long as you infuse yourself with only one force from each possible group.

- For +3 CP you may infuse your natural weapons and unarmed attacks with extra-dimensional energy so that they do double normal damage against opposing types. For +6 CP you may inflict damage of the appropriate type rather than inflicting normal physical damage.

Extra Limbs (6 CP). You have additional arms, legs, or other appendages. This does not grant extra actions, but extra legs do allow the character to use the Quadruped carrying capacity rules and provide a +10 foot bonus to ground movement. Extra arms let you carry more things and may allow the use of two shields at once if the Game Master is feeling generous.

Non-Abilities

Some characters lack one or more ability scores. Such creatures do not have scores of 0; they lack the ability altogether and have no attribute modifier for the attribute. They automatically fail attribute checks based on that attribute. Other effects are noted below. Dropping an ability score costs no CP, but isn't recommended. Characters with non-abilities tend to be virtually unplayable.

- **Strength**: A creature with no Str score can't exert force. If it can attack, it applies its Dex modifier to its base attack bonus instead of its Str modifier.

For +12 CP a creature without a Str score can take on the Incorporeal ability.

- **Dexterity**: A creature with no Dex score can't move. If it can perform actions (such as casting spells), it applies its Intelligence modifier to Initiative checks instead of a Dexterity modifier. It automatically fails Reflex saves.

- **Constitution**: Creatures with no Con aren't alive. They are immune to ability damage, ability drain, energy drain, and effects requiring Fortitude saves unless they work on objects or are harmless. They can't tire, and thus can move, work, or remain alert indefinitely. On the other hand they can't be *Raised* or *Resurrected* and are instantly destroyed at 0 HP.

For +12 CP creatures with no Con scores can gain bonus HP from their size (Small +10, Medium +20, Large +30, Huge +40, Gargantuan +60, and Colossal +80).

- **Intelligence**: Any creature that can think or learn has at least Int 1. Creatures with no Int are mindless automatons operating on simple instincts or programs. Having no minds, they're immune to mind-affecting effects (charms, compulsions, phantasms, patterns, and morale effects). Mindless creatures do not gain level-based CP bonuses.

Creatures always have Wisdom and Charisma scores of at least 1. Otherwise they're objects.



Size Modifications

Playable characters normally occupy the middle of the “organic” portion of the size scale: Small, Medium, and Large. Character’s outside of this range had best have some type of shapeshifting. Beings beyond the organic scale are subject to special rules.

Microscale creatures can’t interact effectively with beings or objects in higher size ranges, take no damage from “falls” (they’re basically weightless), may take days to move an inch, and are too small to see. They’re also extremely fragile; below a certain level of complexity only the strongest life-forces can maintain themselves, and even then they are extremely vulnerable to area-effect attacks - such as a spray of disinfectant.

Grandiose creatures are virtually impervious to attacks which do not affect an appropriately large area. Similarly, their attacks all affect massive areas. Of course, anyone silly enough to get into a physical confrontation with an entity you can see from orbit probably deserves whatever they get.

Size Modifiers:	<i>Str</i>	<i>Dex</i>	<i>Con</i>	<i>AAM</i>	<i>Fall</i>	<i>SM</i>	<i>AC</i>	<i>Re</i>
<i>Microscale</i>								
Subatomic	N/A	N/A	-18	N/A	---	---	--	--
Atomic	N/A	N/A	-16	N/A	---	---	--	--
Molecular	N/A	N/A	-14	N/A	---	---	--	--
Cellular	N/A	N/A	-12	N/A	---	---	--	--
Microscopic	N/A	N/A	-10	N/A	---	---	--	--
Minuscule	N/A	N/A	-8	N/A	---	---	--	--
<i>Organic Scale</i>								
Fine	-8	+8	-6	+8	---	+16	10	--
Diminutive	-6	+6	-4	+4	d1	+12	10	--
Tiny	-4	+4	-2	+2	d2	+8	10	--
Small	-2	+2	-	+1	d4	+4	10	5
Medium	-	-	-	-	d6	0	10	5
Large	+8	-2	+4	-1	d8	-4	12	10
Huge	+16	-4	+8	-2	d10	-8	13	15
Gargantuan	+24	-8*	+12	-4	d12	-12	19	20
Colossal	+32	-16*	+16	-8	d20	-16	24	25
<i>Grandiose</i>								
Mountainous	+40	N/A	+20	Area	d100	-24	30	Sp
Continental	+48	N/A	+24	Area	2d100	-36	36	Sp
Astronomical	+56	N/A	+28	Area	3d100	-48	43	Sp
Planetary	+64	N/A	+32	Area	4d100	-60	51	Sp
Stellar	+72	N/A	+36	Area	5d100	-75	60	Sp
Nebular	+80	N/A	+40	Area	10d100	-90	70	Sp

*: Only -4 for Initiative and AC purposes. Skill checks and fine manipulation are subject to these massive penalties.

**: Ditto. Same as above.

AAM: Armor Class and Attack modifier for the creature.

Fall: Falling damage die used, per 10'. Creatures in the Grandiose category do not usually fall at all. Other things start falling to them. If you can make them fall, it hurts a lot.

SM: Skill Modifier. This adds to stealth skills (and similar skill checks) as well as to any knockback the creature suffers. It’s subtracted from checks for grappling, smashing doors, and similar actions, as well as from any knockback the creature inflicts physically.

Larger creatures thus receive bonus on such activities.

AC: A creature’s basic Natural Armor Class (*i.e.*, hitting a medium sized creature requires “10” if there are no other modifiers).

Re: Reach, in feet. “Sp” indicates “whatever the GM likes” - ranging from tens of feet to light hours.

Special Size Modifications

Physical Enhancements - Devices, Spells, and Psionic Powers which enhance Str, Dex, or Con - lose “+2” from their effectiveness for each level of Growth a creature has, but gain a +2 bonus for each level of Shrinking up to a maximum of +12. Other devices may also fail to work properly when overloaded.

Huge and Gargantuan creatures receive only half the usual benefits of healing spells. Colossal creatures receive only one quarter the usual benefits. Conventional healing magic will not work on creatures on the Grandiose scale.

Growth (48 CP per level). Each level of Growth increases a character’s size by one level with all appropriate modifiers. The Game Master is encouraged to play up problems with living expenses, fitting into normal buildings and vehicles, and getting equipment.

Shrinking (12 CP per level). Each level of Shrinking reduces a character’s size by one level with all appropriate modifiers. “Tiny” and smaller creatures mostly find supplies very cheap but have an extremely hard time dealing with practical matters, such as carrying money.



I swear, the teeth were THIS BIG.

General Notes

Immunities (page 34). Immunities are very common in templates and as creature powers. Common Immunities include extra damage from Critical Hits, Sleep, Subdual Damage, Ability Damage and/or Drain, Fatigue and Exhaustion, Energy Drains, Sleeping, Eating, and/or Breathing, Paralysis, Stunning, Flanking, Spell Immunities, Disease, and Death Effects.

Innate Spell (page 33). A great many creature powers can be treated as Innate Spells, including abilities such as Ability damage or Drain, Breath Weapons, Summon, Gaze Attacks, Paralysis Attacks, and Poisons (Poisons can also be built using "Trick").

As previously noted, "unlimited use" is normally taken to mean "enough times per day that there's no need to keep track during a single encounter." Few abilities actually allow unlimited use.

Occult Sense (page 38). This is commonly used for Blindsense, Blindsight, Tremorsense, and Scent.

Self-Development (page 42). When taken as a part of a Template or Racial Package, Self-Development costs are halved. They don't apply when transformed and are selected and approved by the Game Master - and so won't be as useful to each character or become more effective when applied to low attributes.

Existing Templates

3.0 Half-Celestial, +4 ECL, 159 CP

Special Abilities: Low-Light Vision (Occult Sense, 6), Immunities Acid (6), Cold (12), Disease (6), and Electricity (12), +4 to Saves versus Poison (Resistance, 6), +1 Natural Armor (Defense, 6)

Attribute Modifiers: Str +4 (24), Dex +2 (12), Con +4 (24), Int +2 (12), Wis +4 (24), Cha +4 (24) = 174

Innate Spells: Protection From Evil 3/Day (L1+2 Multiple, 6), Bless and Detect Evil (L1+L1+1 Multiple/Combined, 3), Aid L2, Corrupted, 2), Cure Serious Wounds (L3, +3), Neutralize Poison (L3, +3), Remove Disease (L3, +3), Holy Smite (L4, 6), Dispel Evil (L5, 6), Hallow (L5, 3), NO L6 (Specialized, only for reaching higher levels, 3), Holy Word (L7, 12), Resurrection (L7, 6), Holy Aura 3/Day (L8, 16), Symbol (L8, 6), and Summon Monster IX (L9, 18). Total 96. Corrupted; Gradual availability only; 64 points

All Half-Celestial abilities are considered Corrupted. Yes, that's twice for the Innate Spells. That's unusual, but allowable with the permission of the Game Master. They render the Half-Celestial vulnerable to many Channeling powers, mystic bindings, summoning, and banishment, make them very detectable, keeps them from



being Raised or Resurrected, and tend to make them compulsively "good."

3.5 Half-Celestial, +4 ECL, 167 CP

The 3.5 Half-Celestial has some notable modifications. They always have Wings (Celerity with additional movement mode, Corrupted by need for space, +12 CP), they get Smite Evil 1/Day (Smite, 6 CP), Mass Charm Monster replaces Symbol (No cost), free use of Daylight (upgrade the unused L6 innate spell slot and apply the Innate Magic multiple for free, since it's already inherent, for 7 uses/day for +3 CP. For an additional +3 CP this can be raised to 21 times, which should suffice), they gain Spell Resistance (6 CP) and DR 10/Magic (a base of 36 CP, but double-Specialized; physical attacks only, not versus magical weapons, 9 CP).

On the other hand, they lose the Low-Light Vision (-6 CP), and get resistances instead of immunities to acid, cold, and lightning, reducing those costs to 3, 6, and 6 CP, for a net -15. The overall Corrupted modifier continues to apply, for a net total of +8 CP. The 3.5 Half-Celestial is fairly near the limit for +4 ECL, but still has a 4 CP margin.

3.0 and 3.5 Half-Dragon, +3 ECL, 115 CP

Special Abilities: d6 Natural Weapons (Martial Arts, 3*), Breath Weapon 1/Day (Innate Spell, 6), Low-Light and Darkvision (Occult Sense x2, 12), Immunity to Sleep (6), Paralysis (6), and one Energy Form (12), +4 Natural Armor (Defense, 12*)

Attribute Modifiers: Str +8 (24*), Con +2 (6*), Int +2 (12), and Cha +2 (6*)

Special Modifiers: Any racial hit dice are increased by one size to a maximum of d12's. This may or may not mean anything to a point-buy character. It's been arbitrarily set at 10 CP - enough to boost 5 hit dice by one size each. Player characters normally don't get wings, so that cost is not listed.

*Specialized. These abilities mark the character as an obvious monstrous supernatural being with scales, bulging muscles, and the "Dragon" type. He, she, or it can expect a lot of suspicion and minor difficulties in civilization and in social situations.

3.0 and 3.5 Half-Fiend

The Half-Fiend build is so close to the Half-Celestial build that it really isn't worth writing up. It changes the spell selection and trades in four points' worth of attribute enhancements in favor of natural weapons and an extra resistance.

3.5 Afflicted Lycanthrope, +2 ECL, 64 CP

Shapeshift, (with Attribute Modifiers, Bonus Uses, and Hybrid, Specialized in a particular animal form, 12 CP), Defender (Natural Armor +2, 12 CP), d6 Natural Weapons (Martial Arts, 4 CP*), Low-Light Vision (Occult Sense, 6 CP), Animal Empathy (Mindspeech,



both Specialized and Corrupted to apply to animals of the lycanthropic type only, 2 CP), Scent (Occult Sense, 6), +2 Wisdom (12 CP), Curse of Lycanthropy (Innate Spell, *Curse*, 1/Day. 4* CP and Damage Reduction 5/Silver (Afflicted Lycanthrope, 4* CP)

* While shapeshifted only.

A full lycanthrope normally also derives Feats, Skills, HP, and special abilities from its animal form. Since these vary with the animal but result in an additional ECL modifier, they're simply purchased to fit the animal type and the resulting cost is added to the total.

3.5 Natural Lycanthrope, +3 ECL, 72 CP

The only noticeable difference between the Afflicted and Natural werecreature is Damage Reduction 10/Silver (12 CP instead of 4 CP). While this is enough to boost them up to the next ECL, a few extra talents might be in order to make each one unique.

The "Curse of Lycanthropy" is almost entirely beneficial in d20; it provides a variety of useful enhancements and only causes problems if the wereform has an evil inclination. It also makes it a bit hard to explain why there are any humans left.

Of course, in Point Buy, you eventually have to pay for any powers you get; the "curse" simply causes animalistic madness and allows the victim to use the powers. He or she can bring things under control once he or she actually buys them. Being able to inflict it once per day is normally sufficient; stories about werecreatures rarely have them infecting large numbers of people at once. If that ability is desired, simply add more bonus uses.

Some werecreatures retain enhanced physical abilities in normal form; this simply makes the template more expensive. Others actually have problems such as frightening animals, showing telltale signs in normal form, having to roll will saves against animalistic urges, and so on. Such Corrupted packages are either cheaper or more powerful.

Go ahead; be any kind of werething you want to try out.



...Destroyer of Worlds, Ravager of...

Minor Monster Powers

Breath Weapon. This is usually built using Inherent Spell. Breath Weapons are often Corrupted (only usable every-so-many rounds).

Etherealness. Simply living on another plane costs nothing. Commuting usually requires an innate spell, but accessing the co-existent planes is relatively easy; a *Blink* spell does it repeatedly. A level one or two spell should suffice.

Poison. This is usually built using an Inherent Spell as a supernatural ability. Like it or not, nonmagical poisons usually take more than one round to take effect and work differently on different creatures. It can also be taken as a Trick.

Pounce. This is just Reflex Training (may make a full attack after a charge). It's often Corrupted to allow unarmed attacks only.

Powerful Charge. Augment Attack or Enhanced Strike as required.

Rake. Reflex Training; bonus natural weapon attacks when grappling (usually +12 CP to buy it twice).

Regeneration. This can be purchased as Grant of Aid (the fast-healing variant) coupled with either lots of Damage Reduction (Specialized: converts to stun damage only and Corrupted: not effective versus some attacks) or as Immunity to Death from causes other than "X."

Swallow Whole. Creatures with really big mouths and jaw structures allowing it can swallow a single grabbed creature one size smaller than themselves, two of three sizes smaller, four of three sizes smaller, and so on, with a successful grapple roll. This is simply a Trick. It can be used fairly often but only does damage slowly.

Swarm. A Swarm simply needs Immunity to single-target effects. This is expensive, but it's usually Corrupted to leave them especially vulnerable to area-effect weapons and things like *Gust of Wind*. Buying some area-effect damage is an optional extra.

Trample. Creatures with four or more legs and hard feet (or hard foot coverings) may attempt to trample creatures at least one size smaller than themselves. Creatures with two legs can attempt to trample creatures at least two sizes smaller than themselves, but must make a DC 18 Reflex save to avoid falling. No save is required if the target is at least three sizes smaller than the trampler. This isn't really a special ability.